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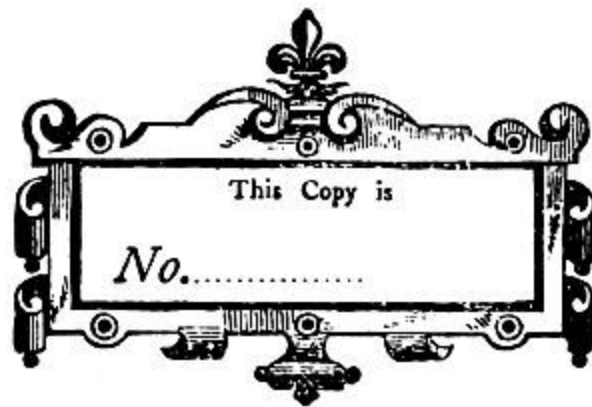
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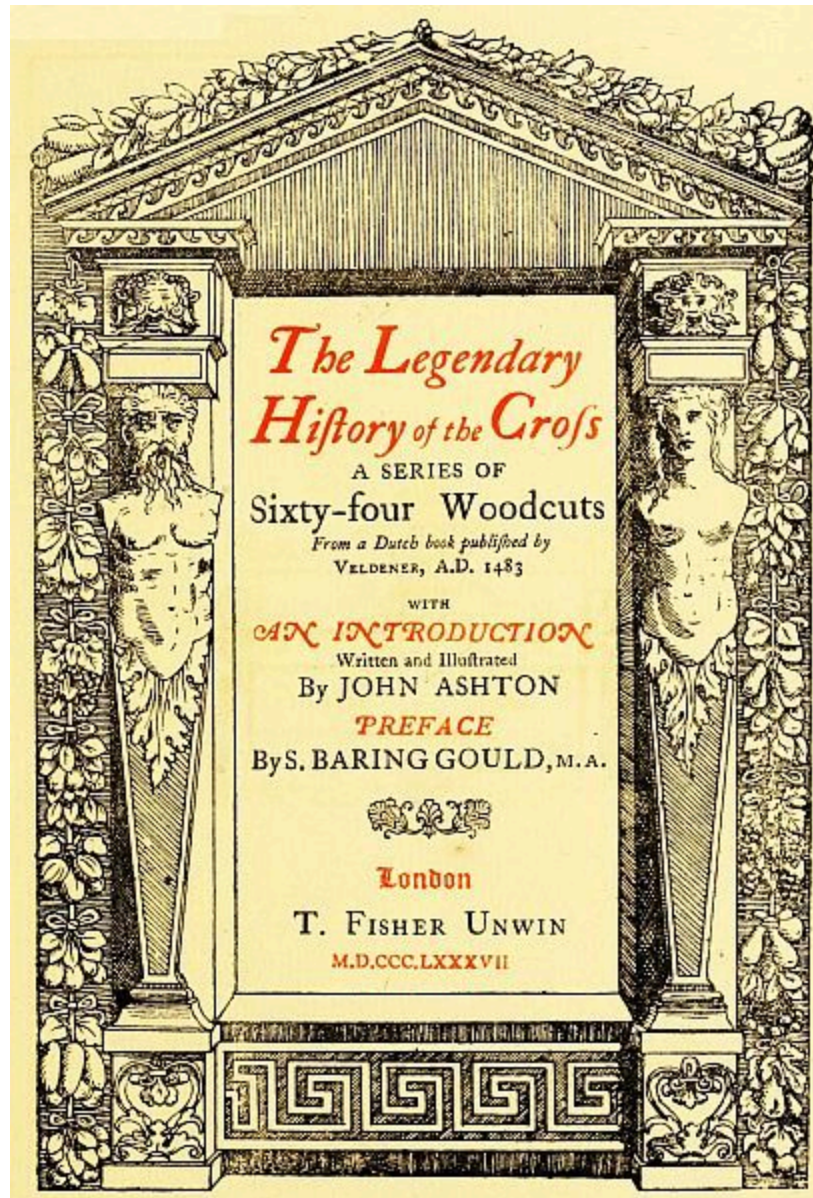
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LEGENDARY HISTORY OF THE CROSS ***

Transcriber's Notes: All spelling, capitalization, and
punctuation inconsistencies retained.

The Legendary History of the Cross.





The Legendary History of the Cross

A SERIES OF
Sixty-four Woodcuts
From a Dutch book published by
VELDENER, A.D. 1483

WITH
AN INTRODUCTION
Written and Illustrated
By JOHN ASHTON

PREFACE
By S. BARING GOULD, M.A.

London
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PREFACE.



THE origin of the mediæval romance of the Cross is hard to discover. It was very popular. It occurs in a good number of authors, and is depicted in a good many churches in stained glass.

I may perhaps be allowed here to repeat what I have said in my article on the Legend of the Cross, in “Myths of the Middle Ages:”—

“In the churches of the city of Troyes alone it appears in the windows of four: S. Martin-ès-Vignes, S. Pantaléon, S. Madeleine, and S. Nizier. It is frescoed along the walls of the choir of S. Croce at Florence, by the hand of Agnolo Gaddi. Pietro della Francesca also dedicated his pencil to the history of the Cross in a series of frescoes in the chapel of the Bacci, in the church of S. Francesco at Arezzo. It occurs as a predella painting among the specimens of early art at the Accademia delle Belle Arti at Venice, and is the subject of a picture by Beham, in the Munich Gallery. The Legend is told in full in the ‘Vita Christi,’ printed at Troyes in 1517; in the ‘Legenda Aurea’ of Jacques de Voragine; in a French MS. of the thirteenth century, in the British Museum. Gervase of Tilbury relates a portion of it in his ‘Otia Imperialia,’ quoting Peter Comestor; it appears in the ‘Speculum Historiale’ of Gottfried of Viterbo, in the ‘Chronicon Engelhusii,’ and elsewhere.”

In the very curious Creation window of S. Neot’s Church, Cornwall, Seth is represented putting three pips of the Tree of Life into the mouth and nostrils of dead Adam, as he buries him.

Of the popularity of the story of the Cross there can be no doubt, but its origin is involved in obscurity. It is generally possible to track most of the religious and popular folk tales and romances of the Middle Ages to their origin, which is frequently Oriental, but it is not easy to do so with the Legend of the Cross. It would rather seem that it was made up by some romancer out of all kinds of pre-existing material, with no other object than

to write a religious novel for pious readers, to displace the sensuous novels which were much in vogue.

We know that this was largely done after the third century, and a number of martyr legends, such as those of S. Apollinaris Syncletica, SS. Cyprian and Justina, the story of Duke Procopius, S. Euphrosyne, SS. Zosimus and Mary, SS. Theophanes and Pansemne, and many others were composed with this object. The earliest of all is undoubtedly the Clementine Recognitions, which dates from a remotely early period, and carries us into the heart of Petrine Christianity, and in which many a covert attack is made on S. Paul and his teaching. On the other hand, we know that an Asiatic priest, as Tertullian tells us, wrote a romance on "Paul and Thecla, out of love to Paul." S. Jerome says that a Pauline zealot, when convicted before his bishop of having written the romance, tried to exculpate himself by saying that he had done it out of admiration for S. Paul, but the Bishop would not accept the excuse, and deprived him. Unfortunately this romance has not come down to us, though we have another on S. Paul and his relations to Thecla, who is said to have accompanied him on his apostolic rambles, disguised in male attire.

The Greek romance literature was not wholesome reading for Christians. Some of the writers of these tales became Christian bishops, and probably devoted their facile pens to more edifying subjects than the difficulties of parted lovers.

Heliodorus, who wrote "Theagenes and Charicheia," is said to have become Bishop of Tricca, in Thessaly. Socrates, in the fifth century, in speaking of clerical celibacy, mentions the severity of the rule imposed on his clergy by this Heliodorus, "under whose name there are love-books extant, called Ethiopica, which he composed in his youth."

Achilles Tatius, author of the "Loves of Clitophon and Leucippe," is said also to have become a bishop. So also Eustathius of Thessalonica, author of the "Lives of Hysemene and Hysmenias," but this is more than doubtful.

Three things conduced to the production of a Christian romance literature in the early ages of the Church:—(1) The necessity under which the Church lay of supplying a want in human nature; (2) The need there was for producing some light wholesome literature to supply the place of the

popular love-romances then largely read and circulated; (3) The fact that some bishops and converts were experienced novel writers, and therefore ready to lend their hands to some better purpose than amusing the leisure and flattering the passions of the idle and young.

Much the same conditions existed in the Middle Ages. There was an influx of sensuous literature from the East, through the Arabs of Spain and Sicily; Oriental tales easily took Western garb, in which the caliphs became kings of Christendom, and the fakirs and imauns were converted into monks and Catholic priests. To counteract these stories, collections of which may be found in Le Grand d'Aussi and Von der Hagen, and in Boccaccio, the *Gesta Romanorum* was drawn up, a collection of moral tales, many of them of similar Oriental parentage. But beside these short stories, or novels, were long romances, some heroic, and founded on early national traditions and ballads. To these belong the *Nibelungen Lied* and *Noth*, the *Gudrun*, the *Heldenbuch*, the cycles of Karlovingian and of Arthurian romance.

As it happens, we have two authors in the Middle Ages, living much about the same time, one intensely heathen in all his conceptions, the other as entirely Christian, each dealing with subjects from the same cycle, and the one writing in avowed opposition to the tendency of the other's book. I allude to Wolfram of Eschenbach and Gottfried of Strassburg. The latter wrote the *Tristram*, the former the *Parzival*. In Gottfried, the moral sense seems to be absolutely dead; there is no perception of the sacredness of truth, of chastity, of honour, none of religion. Wolfram is his exact converse. Wolfram gives us the history of the Grail, but he did not invent the myth of the Grail, he derived it from pre-existing material. The Grail myth is almost certainly heathen in its origin, but it has been entirely Christianised. The holy basin is that in which the Blood of Christ is preserved, and only the pure of heart can see it; but the Grail was really the great cauldron of Nature, the basin of Ceridwen, the earth goddess of the Kelts, or, among Teutonic nations, the sacrificial cauldron of Odin, in which was brewed the spirit of poesy, of the blood of Mimer. The remembrance of the mysterious vessel remained after Kelt and Teuton had become Christian, and the poets and romancists gave it a new spell of life by christening it. It was much the same with the story of the Cross. In the Teutonic North, tree worship was widely spread; the tree was sacred to Odin, who himself,

according to the mysterious Havamal, hung nine nights wounded, as a sacrifice to himself, a voluntary sacrifice, in “the wind-rocked tree.”

That tree was Yggdrasill, the world tree, whose roots extended to hell, and whose branches spread to heaven.

Northern mythology is full of allusion to this tree, but we have, unfortunately, little of the history of it preserved to us; we know of it only through allusions. The Christmas tree is its representative; it has been taken up out of paganism, and rooted in Christian soil, where it flourishes to the annual delight of thousands of children.

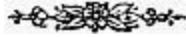
Now the mediæval romancists laid hold of this tree, as they laid hold of the Grail basin, and used it for Christian purposes. The Grail cup became the chalice of the Blood of Christ, and the Tree of Odin became the Cross of Calvary. They worked into the romance all kinds of material gathered from floating folk-tale of heathen ancestry, and they pieced in with it every scrap of allusion to a tree they could find in Scripture. It is built up of fragments taken from all kinds of old structures, put together with some skill, and built into a goodly romance; but the tracing of every stone to its original quarry has not been done by anyone as yet. The Grail myth has had many students and interpreters, but not the Cross myth. That remains to be examined, and it will doubtless prove a study rewarding the labour of investigation.

S. BARING-GOULD.





The Legendary History of the Cross.



THE Cross on which our Lord and Saviour suffered, would, naturally, if properly authenticated, be an object of the deepest veneration to all Christian men, be their creed, or shade of opinion what it might; but, for over 300 years it could not be found, and it was reserved for the Empress Helena in her old age (for she was 79 years old) to discover its place of concealment.¹ That this *Invention*, or finding of the Cross was believed in, at the time, there can be no manner of doubt, for it is alluded to by St. Cyril, Patriarch of Jerusalem (A.D. 350 to 386), and by St. Ambrose. Rufinus of Aquila, a friend of St. Jerome, in his *Ecclesiastical History*, gives an account of its finding, in the following words: “About the same time, Helena, the mother of Constantine, a woman of incomparable faith, whose sincere piety was equalled by her rare munificence, warned by celestial visions, went to Jerusalem, and inquired of the inhabitants where was the place where the Divine Body had been affixed and hung on a gibbet. This place was difficult to find, for the persecutors of old had raised a statue to Venus,² in order that the Christians who might wish to adore Christ in that place, should appear to address their homage to the goddess; and thus it was little frequented, and almost forgotten. After clearing away the profane objects which defiled it, and the rubbish that was there heaped up, she found three crosses placed in confusion. But the joy which this discovery caused her was tempered by the impossibility of distinguishing to whom each of them had belonged. There, also, was found the title written by Pilate in Greek, Latin, and Hebrew characters; but still there was nothing to indicate sufficiently clearly the Cross of our Lord. This uncertainty of man was settled by the testimony of heaven.” And then follows the story of the dead woman being raised to life.

¹A.D. 326.

*Rufinus on the
Invention.*

²*Hadrian is said to
have done this.*

Not only did Rufinus write thus, but Socrates, Theodoret, and Sozomen, all of whom lived within a century after the *Invention*, tell the same story, so that it must have been of current belief.

Other Authorities.

The punishment of the Cross was a very ordinary one, and of far wider extent than many are aware. It was common among the Scythians, the Greeks, the Carthaginians, the Germans, and the Romans, who, however, principally applied it to their slaves, and rarely crucified free men, unless they were robbers or assassins.

Punishment of the Cross.

Alexander the Great, after taking the city of Tyre, caused two thousand inhabitants to be crucified.

Flavius Josephus relates, in his *Antiquities of the Jews*, that Alexander, the King of the Jews, on the capture of the town of Betoma, ordered eight hundred of the inhabitants to suffer the death of the Cross, and their wives and children to be massacred before their eyes, whilst they were still alive.

Punishment of the Cross.

Augustus, after the Sicilian War, crucified six thousand slaves who had not been claimed by their masters.

Tiberius crucified the priests of Isis, and destroyed their temple.

Titus, during the siege of Jerusalem, crucified all those unfortunates who, to the number of five or six hundred daily, fled from the city to escape the famine; and so numerous were these executions, that crosses were wanting, and the land all about seemed like a hideous forest.

These instances are sufficient to show that death by crucifixion was a common punishment; but, singularly enough, the shape of the Cross has never been satisfactorily settled; practically, the question lies between the *Crux capitata*, or *immissa*, which is the ordinary form of the Latin Cross, and the *Crux ansata*, or *commissa*, frequently called the *Tau* Cross, from the Greek letter T. The *Tau*-shaped Cross is, undoubtedly, to be met with most frequently in the older representations; and the more ancient authorities, such as Tertullian, St. Jerome, St. Paulinus, Sozomen, and Rufinus, are of

The different sorts of Crosses.

opinion that this was the shape of the Cross. After the fifteenth century, our Lord is rarely depicted on the *Crux commissa*, it being reserved for the two thieves.

M. Adolphe Napoleon Didron, in his *Iconographie Chretienne*, gives a few illustrations of the antiquity of the *Tau* Cross: “The Cross is our crucified Lord in person; ‘Where the Cross is, there is the martyr,’ says St. Paulinus. Consequently it works miracles, as does Jesus Himself: and the list of wonders operated by its power is in truth immense. By the simple sign of the Cross traced upon the forehead or the breast, men have been delivered from the most imminent danger. It has constantly put demons to flight, protected the virginity of women, and the faith of believers; it has restored men to life, or health, inspired them with hope or resignation.

Antiquity of the Tau Cross.

“Such is the virtue of the Cross, that a mere allusion to that sacred sign, made even in the Old Testament, and long before the existence of the Cross, saved the youthful Isaac from death, redeemed from destruction an entire people whose houses were marked by that symbol, healed the envenomed bites of those who looked at the serpent raised in the form of a *Tau* upon a pole. It called back the soul into the dead body of the son of that poor widow who had given bread to the prophet.

“A beautiful painted window, belonging to the thirteenth century, in the Cathedral of Bourges, has a representation of Isaac bearing on his shoulders the wood that was to be used in his sacrifice, arranged in the form of a Cross; the Hebrews, too, marked the lintel of their dwellings with the blood of the Paschal lamb, in the form of a *Tau* or Cross without a summit. The widow of Sarepta picked up and held crosswise two pieces of wood, with which she intended to bake her bread. These figures, to which others also may be added, serve to exalt the triumph of the Cross, and seem to flow from a grand central picture which forms their source, and exhibits Jesus expiring on the Cross. It is from that real Cross indeed, bearing the Saviour, that these subjects from the Old Testament derive all their virtue.”

The Tau Cross.

The wood of which it was made is as unsettled as its shape. The Venerable Bede says that our Lord’s Cross

Wood of the Cross.

was made of four kinds of wood: the inscription of box, the upright beam of cypress, the transverse of cedar, and the lower part of pine. John Cantacuméne avers that only three woods were employed: the upright, cedar; the transverse, pine; and the head in cypress. Others say that the upright was cypress, the transverse in palm, and the head in olive; or cedar, cypress, and olive. Most authorities seem to concur that it was made of several woods, but there is a legend that it was made from the aspen tree, whose leaves still tremble at the awful use the tree was put to; whilst that veritable traveller, Sir John Maundeville, says: “And also in Iherusalem toward the Weast is a fayre church where the tree grew of the which the Crosse was made.” Lipsius says that it was made of but one wood, and that was oak; but M. Rohault de Fleury (to whose wonderful and comprehensive work, *Mémoire sur les Instruments de la Passion de notre Sauveur Jesus Christ*, I am deeply indebted, says, “M. Decaisne, member of the Institut, and M. Pietro Savi, professor at the University of Pisa, have shewn me by the microscope that the pieces in the Church of the Holy Cross of Jerusalem at Rome, in the Cathedral at Pisa, in the Duomo at Florence, and in Notre Dame at Paris, were of *pine*.” And he adds, in a footnote, “Independently of the experiments which M. Savi kindly made in my presence, he wrote me the results of other observations, which tended to confirm.”

Cross made of pine.

Starting with the Invention of the Holy Cross, the loving, but fervid, imaginations of the faithful soon wove round it a covering of imagery, as we have just seen in the case of the several woods of the Cross, and the sacred tree became the subject of a legend (for so it always was only meant to be), which was incorporated in the *Legenda Aurea Sanctorum*, or *Golden Legend of the Saints*, of Jacobus de Voragine, a collection of legends connected with the services of the Church. This book was exceedingly popular, and, when Caxton set up his printing-press at Westminster, he produced a translation, the history of which he quaintly tells us in a preface.

[\[A\]](#)

As this Golden Legend is the standard authority on the subject, and as it will much assist the intelligent appreciation of the wood-blocks, I reproduce it, premising that I have used throughout the first edition, 20 Nov., 1483:—

Caxton's Golden Legend

³ But alle the dayes of adam lyvyng here in erthe
amounte to the somme of ~~ix~~^{ix} ~~xxx~~^{xxx} ~~ii~~ⁱⁱ ~~l~~^l yere / And in thende
of his lyf whan he shold dye / it is said but of none
auctoryte / that he sente Seth his sone in to paradys for
to fetch the oyle of mercy / where he receyuyde certayn
graynes of the fruyt of the tree of mercy by an angel /
And whan he come agayn / he fonde his fader adam yet
alyve and told hym what he had don. And thenne Adam

³Page 39.

⁴Laughed or smiled.

⁵Obtained true
mercy.

lawhed⁴ first / and then deyed / and thenne he leyd the greynes or kernellis
under his faders tonge and buried hym / in the vale of ebron / and out of his
mouth grewe thre trees of the thre graynes / of which the crosse that our
lord suffred his passion on / was made by vertue of which he gate⁵ very
mercy and was brought out of darknes in to veray light of heven / to the
whiche he brynge us that lyveth and regneth god world with oute ende.



Of thynuencion of tholy
crosse / and first of thys worde
Inuencion

T

 HE⁶ Invencion[C] of the holy crosse is said
 bycause that this day the holy crosse was founden /
 for to fore⁷ it was founden of seth in paradyse terestre /
 lyke as hit shal be sayd here after / and also it was
 founden of salamon in the mounthe of lybane and of the
 quene of saba / in the temple of salamon / And of the Iewes in the water of
 pyscyne[D] / And on thys day it was founden of Helayne in the mounthe of
 Calvarye/.

⁶Page 167.

⁷Of old.

Of the Holy Crosse.

T

 HE holy crosse was founden two hondred yere
 after the resurrexyon of our lord / It is redde in the
 gospel of nychodemus[E] / that whan adam wexyd seck /
 Seth hys sone wente to the gate of paradyse terestre, for
 to gete the oyle of mercy for to enoynte wythal hys
 faders body / Thenne apperyd to hym saynt mychel
 thaungel and sayd to hym / travayle not the in vayne /
 for thys oyle / for thou mayst not have it till fyve
 thousand and fyve hondred yere been passed / how be it
 that fro Adam unto the passyon of our lord were but fyve
~~mc~~ and ~~xxiii~~ yere / In another place it is redde that the
 aungel broughte hym a braunche / and commaunded
 hym to plante it in the mounthe of lybanye Yet fynde we
 in another place / that he gafe to hym of the tree that
 Adam ete of / And sayd to hym that whan that bare
 fruyte he should be guarisshed⁸ and alle hoole⁹ /. whan
 seth came ageyn he founde his fader deed / and planted
 this tree upon his grave / And it endured there un to the
 tyme of Salomon / and bycause he sawe that it was
 fayre, he dyd¹⁰ doo hewe it doun / and sette it in his
 hows named saltus / and whan the quene of saba came to
 vysyte Salamon / She worshypped this tre bycause she
 sayd the savyour of alle the world shold be hanged there
 on / by whome the royame¹¹ of the Iewes that be
 defaced and seace.¹² Salomon for this cause made hit to

⁸Cured: French, *guérir*, to heal.

⁹Whole.

¹⁰Did so—caused to be: words of frequent occurrence.

¹¹Kingdom: French, *royaume*.

¹²Cease.

¹³Dug, p. part. of delve.

¹⁴Pond.

¹⁵The L[a]b[a]rum, or Sacred Banner of Constantine.

be taken up / & dolven¹³ depe in the grounde. Now it
 happed after that they of Ierusalem (dyd do make a grete
 pytte for a pyscye¹⁴ / where at the mynysters of the
 temple sholde wesshe theyre bestys / that they shold
 sacrefyse / and there founde thys tre / and thys pyscye
 had suche vertue, that the aungels descended and mevyd
 the water / and the first seke man that descendyd in to
 the water after the mevyng / was made hole of what
 somever sekenesse he was seek of. And whan the tyme approched of the
 passyon of our lord / thys tree aroos out of the water and floted above the
 water / And of this pyece of tymbre made the Iewes the crosse of our lord /
 Thenne after this hystorye / the crosse by which we been saved / came of
 the tree by whiche we were dampned. And the water of that pyscye had
 not his vertue onely of the aungel / but of the tre/. With this tre wherof the
 crosse was maad / there was a tree that went over thwarte / on whiche the
 armes of our lord were nayled/. And another pyece above which was the
 table / wherin the tytle was wryten / and another pyece wherein the sokette
 or mortys was maad that the body of the crosse stood in soo that there were
 foure manere of trees / That is of palme of cypres / of cedre and of olyve.
 So eche of thyse foure pyeces was of one of those trees/. This blessed
 crosse was put in the erthe and hyd by the space of on hondred yere and
 more / But the moder of themperour which was named helayne[F] which
 founde it in thys manere / For Constantyn came wyth a grete multytude of
 barbaryns nygh unto the ryver of the dunoe / whyche wold have goon over
 for to have destroyed alle the contree / And whan constantyn had assembled
 his hoost / He went and sette them ageynst that other partye / But as sone as
 he began to passe the ryver / he was moche aferde / by cause he shold on
 the morne have batayle / and in the nyght as he slepte in his bedde / an
 aungel awoke hym / and shewed to hym the sygne of the crosse in heven /
 and sayd to hym / Beholde on hys on heven/. Thanne sawe he the crosse
 made of ryght clere lyght / & was wryten there upon wyth lettres of golde /
 In this sygne thou shalte over come the batayle/ Thenne was he alle
 comforted of thys vysion / And on the morne / he put in his banere the
 Crosse¹⁵ / and made it to be borne tofore hym and his hoost / And after
 smote in the hoost of his enemyes / and slewe and chaced grete plente /
 After thys he dyd doo¹⁶ calle the bysshoppes of the ydolles / and
 demaunded them to what god the sygne of the crosse apperteyned. And

¹⁶*Caused to be called together.*

¹⁷*Know.*

¹⁸*Grandfather.*

whan they coude not answeare / some cristen men that were there tolde to hym the mysterye of the crosse / and enformed hym in the faythe of the trynyte / Thenne anone he bylevyd parfytylly (in) god / and dyd do baptyse hym / and after, it happed that constantyn his sone remembred the vycorye of his fader / Sente to helayn his modre for to fynde the holy crosse / Thenne helayne wente in to Iherusalem / and dyd doo assemble all the wyse men of the contre / and whan they were assembled / they wold fayn knowe wherfore they were called / Thenne one Iudas sayd to them / I wote¹⁷ wel that she wyl knowe of us where the crosse of Ihesu criste was leyd / but beware you al that none of you tell hyr / for I wote wel then shall our lawe be destroyed / For zacheus my olde¹⁸ fader sayde to symon my fader / And my fader sayde to me at his dethe / be wel ware / that for no tormente that ye may suffre / telle not where the crosse of Ihesu criste was leyde / for after that hit shal be founden / the Iewes shal reygne no mour / But the cristen men that worshypped the crosse shal then reygne / And verayly this Ihesus was the sone of god.



Then demaunded I my fader / wherfore had they hanged hym on the crosse sythe it was knowen that he was the sone of god / thenne he sayd to me fayre sone I never accorded thereto / But gayn said it alwaye / But the Pharisees dyd it bycause he repreyvd theyr vyces / but he aroos on the thyrd day / and his dysciples seeing / he ascended in to heven / Thenne by cause that Stephen thy broder belevyd in him / the Iewes stoned hym to dethe.

Then when Iudas had sayd theyse wordes to his selawes / they answerd we never herde of suche thynges / never the lesse kepe the wel if the quene demaunde the therof / that thou say no thyng to hyr / Whan the quene had called them / and demaunded them the place where our lord Ihesu criste had been crucefyed/ they wold never tell her nor ensygne¹⁹ her /. Then commaunded she to brenne²⁰ them alle/. But then

¹⁹Inform.

²⁰Burn.

they doubted and were aferde / & delyvered Iudas to hyr and sayd / lady thys man is the sone of a prophete and of a juste man / and knoweth right wel the lawe / & can telle to you al thyng that ye shal demaunde hym/.

Thenne the quene lete al the other goo, and reteyned Iudas without moo²¹/. Thenne she shewed to hym his life & dethe & bade hym chese whyche he wold. Shewe to me sayd she the place named golgota where our lord was crucefyed / by cause and to the end that we may fynde the crosse/. Thenne sayd Iudas, it is two hondred yere passed & more / & I was not thenne yet borne. Thenne sayd to hym the lady / by him that was crucefyed / I shal make the perisse for hungre/ yf thou telle not to me the trouthe.

²¹*More ado.*

Thenne made she hym to be caste into a drye pytte / and there tormented hym by hungre / and evyl reste / whan he had been seuen dayes in that pytte / thenne sayd he yf I myght be drawen out / he shold say the trouthe / Thenne he was drawen out / and whan he came to the place / anone the erthe moevyd and a fume of grete swetnesse was felte in suche wyse that Iudas smote his hondes togyder for ioie / and sayd / in trouthe Ihesu criste thou art the savyour of the worlde.

It was so that adryan the Emperour had doo make in the same place where the crosse laye a temple of a goddesse by cause that all they that come in that place shold adoure that goddesse/. But the quene did doo destroy the temple / Thenne Iudas made hym redy and began to dygge / and whan he came to ~~be~~ paas²² depe / he fonde three crosses and broughte them to the quene / And bycause he knewe not whiche was the crosse of our lord / he leyd them in the myddel of the cyte / and abode the demonstraunce of god / and aboute the houre of none / there was the corps of a yonge man brought to be buried / Iudas reteyned the byere / and layed upon hit one of the crosses / and after the second / and whan he leyd on hit the third / anone the body that was dede came ageyn to lyf/.

²²*Twenty Paces.*

Thenne cryed the devyll in the eyre Iudas what hast thou doon / thou hast doon the contrarye that thother Iudas dyd/. For by hym I have wonne many sowles / and by the I shal lose many / by hym I reygned on the peple / And by the I have

²³*Everlasting.*

lost my royame / never the lesse I shal yelde to the this bountee/. For I shal send one that shal punyssh the / and that was accomplysshed by Iulian the apostata / which tormented hym afterward whan he was bysshop of Iherusalem / and whan Iudas herde hym he cursed the devyl and sayd to hym / Ihesu cryste dampne the in fyre pardurable²³/. After this Iudas was baptyzed and was named quyryache[G]/. And after was made bysshop of Iherusalem/. Whan helayn had the crosse of Ihesu criste / and saw she had not the nayles / Thenne he dyd dygge in therthe so longe / that he founde them shynyng as golde/. thenne bare he them to the quene / and anone as she sawe them she worshypped them wyth grete reverence/.

Thenne gafe saynt helayn a part of the crosse to hir sone / And that other parte she left in Iherusalem closyd in golde / sylver and precious stones/.

And hyr sone bare the nayles to themperour / And the emperour dyd do sette them in hys brydel and in hys helme whan he wente to batayle/. This referreth Eusebe whiche was bysshop of Cezayr²⁴/ how be it that other say otherwyse/. Now it happed that Iulyan the appostate dyd doo²⁵ slee quyriache that was bysshop of Iherusalem / by cause he had founde the crosse / for he hated hit soo mooche / that where somever he founde the crosse / he dyd hit to be destroyed / For whan he wente in batayle ageynste them of perse / he sente and commaunded quyriache to make sacrefyse to thydolles / and whan he wold not doo hit / he dyd do smyte of his right honde / and sayd wyth this honde hast thou wryten many letters / by whyche thou repellyd moche folke fro doynge sacrefyse to our goddes/.

²⁴*Eusebius, Bishop of Cesaræa.*

²⁵*Killed.*

Quyriache sayd thou wood hounde²⁶ thou hist doon to me grete prouffyte / For thou hast cut of the hande / wyth whiche I have many tymes wretton to the synagoges that they shold not byleve in Ihesu criste / and now sythe²⁷ I am cristen / thou hast taken from me that whiche noyed me / thenne dyd Iulyan do melte leed, and caste it in his mowthe / and after dyd doo brynge a bedde of yron / and made quyriache to be layed and stratched theron / and after leyd under brennyng cooles / and threwe therein grece and salte / for to torment hym the more / and whan quyriache moved not / Iulyan

²⁶*Mad dog.*

²⁷*Since.*

²⁸*Turn this evil*

themperour said to hym / outhur thou shalt sacrefyse (to) our goddes / or thou shalt say at the leste thou art not cristen/. And whan he sawe he wolde not do never neyther / he dyd doo make a depe pytte ful of serpentis and venemous bestys / and caste hym therein / & whan he entred / anone the serpentis were al deed/. Thenne Iulyan put hym in a cawdron ful of boylyng oyle / and whan he shold entre in to hit / he blessyd it & sayd / Fayre lord torne thys bane²⁸ to baptyism of marterdom / Thenne was Iulyan moche angry / and commaunded that he should be ryven thorough his herte with a swerde / and in this manere he fynnysshed his lyff.

The vertue of the crosse is declared to us by many miracles / For it happed on a tyme that one enchantour had dysceyved a notarye / and brought hym to a place / where he had assembled a grete companye of devylles / and promysed to hym to have muche rychesse / and whan he came there / he saw one persone blacke syttyng on a grete chayer / And all aboute hym al ful of horyble people and blacke whiche had speres and swerdes / Thenne demaunded thys grete devyll of the enchantour / who was that clerke / thenchantour sayd to hym / Syr he is oures / thenne sayd the devyl to hym yf thou wylte worshyp me and be my servaunte / and denye Ihesu cryste / thou shalt sytte on my right syde / The clerke anone blessyd hym wyth the sygne of the crosse / and sayd that he was the servaunte of Ihesu criste / his savyour / And anone as he had made the crosse / that grete multitude of devylles vanysshed awaye. It happed that this notarye after this on a tyme entryd with hys lord in the chyrche of saynt sophye / & knelyd doun on his knees to fore the ymage of the crucifyxe / the which crucifyxe as it semed lokyd moche openly and sharpelye on hym/. Thenne his lord made hym to go aparte on another syde / and alleweye the crucifixe turned his eyen toward hym/. Thenne he made hym goo on the lefte syde / and yet the crucifixe lokyd on hym / Thenne was the lord moche admerveyled / and charged hym & commaunded hym that he shold telle hym wherof he had so deserved that the crucifyxe so behelde and lokyd on hym / Thenne sayde the notarye that he coude not remembre hym of no good thyng that he had doon / saufe that one tyme he wold not renye nor forsake the crucifixe tofore the devyl/.

Thenne late us so blesse us with the sygne of the blessyd crosse that we may therby be kepte fro the power of our ghoostly and dedely enemye the

devyl / and by the glorious passyon that our saveour Ihesu cryst suffred on the crosse after this lyf we may come to his everlastyng blysse amen/.

Thus endeth thynvencion of the holy crosse.



Here foloweth the Exaltacion
of the holy Crosse

Exaltation of the holy Crosse²⁹ is sayd / bycause that on this daye the hooly crosse & faythe were gretely enhaunced/. And it is to be understonden that tofore the passion of our lord Ihesu cryste / the tree of the crosse was a tree of fylthe / For the crosses were made of vyle trees, & of trees without fruyte / For al that was planted on the Mount of Calvarye bare no fruyt. It was a fowle place / for hit was the place of torment of thevys / It was derke / for it was in a derke place and without any beaute / It was the tree of deth / for men were put there to dethe / It was also the tree of stenche / for it was planted amonge the caroynes³⁰ / & after the passyon the Crosse was moche enhaunced / For the Vylte³¹ was transported into preciousyte / Of the whiche the blessyd saynt Andrewe sayth / O precious holy Crosse god save the / his bareynes was torned into fruyte / as it is sayd in the Cantiques / I shall ascende up in to a palme tree / et cetera / His ignobylyte or unworthynes was tourned into sublymyte and heyght / The Crosse that was tormente of thevys is now born in the front of themperours / his derkenes is torned into lyght and clerenesse/ wherof Chrysostom sayth the Crosse and the Woundes shall be more shynnyng than the rayes of the Sonne at the jugement / his deth is converted into perdurabylyte of lyf / whereof it is sayd in the preface / that fro hens the lyf resourded³² / and the stenche is torned into swetenes / canticorum /. This exaltacion of the hooly crosse is solempnysed and halowed solempnly of the Chirche / For the faythe is in hit moche enhaunced /.

²⁹*The Roman and English Churches celebrate this Festival on February 14.*

³⁰*Carrion.*

³¹*Vileness.*

³²*Resourced or replenished.*

For the yere of oure lord five honderd & ~~viii~~ / our lord suffred his people moche to be tormentyd by the cruelte of the paynymys / And Cosdroe³³ Kynge of the Perceens subdued to his empyre all the Royaumes of the world / And he cam into Iherusalem and was aferd and a dred of the sepulcre of our lord & retorned / but he bare with hym the parte of the hooly Crosse / that saynte Helene had left ther. And then he wold be worshiped of alle the peple / as a god / & dyd do make a tour of gold and of sylver wherein precious stones shone / and made therein the ymages of the sonne and of the mone and of the sterres / and made that by subtile conduytes water to be hydde / and to come doune in the maner of rayne / And in the laste stage he made

³³*Chosroes II., who reigned in the seventh Century.*

horses to draw charyotes round aboute lyke as they had mevyd the toure / and made it to seme as it had thondred / and delyvered his Royaume to his sone. And thus this cursyd man abode in this Temple / and dyd doo sette the crosse of our lord by hym and commaunded that he shold be callyd god of alle the peple / And as it is redde in libro de mitrali^[H] officio the said Cosdroe resydent in his trone as a fader / sette the tree of the Crosse on his ryght syde in stede of the sonne / and a cock in the lyft syde in stede of the hooly ghoost / & commaunded / that he shold be called fader /. And then Heracle^[I] themperour assembled a grete hoost / and cam for to fyght wyth the sonne of Cosdroe by the ryver of danubie / & thenne hit pleasyd to eyther prynce / that eche of them shold fyght one ageynste that other upon the brydge / & he that shold vaynquysshe & overcome his adversarye sholde be prynce of thempyre withoute hurtyng eyther of bothe hostes / & so hit was ordeyned & sworn / & that who somever shold helpe his prynce shold have forthwith his legges & armes cut of / & to be plunged / & cast in to the Ryver.

And then Heracle commaunded hym all to god and to the hooly crosse wyth all the devocion that he myght. And thenne they fought longe / And at the last our lord gaf the vycory to Heracle and subdued hym to his empyre / The hoost that was contrary / and alle the peple of Cosdroe obeyed them to the Crysten faythe / and receyved the hooly baptysme / And Cosdroe knew not the end of the batayll / For he was adoured and worshiped of alle the peple as a god / so that no man durst say nay to him / And thenne Heracle came to hym / and fonde hym syttinge in his syege³⁴ of golde / and sayd to hym / For as moche as after the manere thou hast honoured the Tree of the Crosse / yf thou wyld receyve baptym and the faythe of Ihesu Cryst / I shal gete it to the / and yet shalt thou holde thy crowne and Royamme with lytel hostages / And I shall lete the have thy lyf / and yf thou wylt not / I shall flee the wyth my swerde / and shalle smyte of thyne heed / and whanne he wold not accorde therto / he did anon do smyte of his hede / and commaunded that he shold be buried / by cause he

³⁴*Throne, or seat;
French, siège.*

³⁵*Astonished.*

³⁶*Shoen—shoes.*

³⁷*Besprinkled.*

³⁸*Invited.*

³⁹*Pacified,
appeased.*

⁴⁰*Ampullæ, bottles
or flasks.*

⁴¹*Consecrated.*

had be(en) a Kynge /. And he fonde with hym one his sone of the age of ten yere / whome he dyd doo baptyse and lyft hym fro the fonte / and left to hym the Royaume of his fader / and then he dyd doo breke that Toure / And gaf the sylver to them of his hooste / and gaf the gold and precious stones for to repayre the chirches that the tyraunt had destroyed / and tooke the hoole crosse / and brought it ageyne to Ierusalem / and as he descended from the mount of Olyvete / and wold have entryd by the gate by whiche our savyour wente to his passyon on horsbacke adourned as a Kynge / sodenly the stones of the gates descended / and ioyned them togyder in the gate like a wall & all the peple was abashed³⁵ / and thenne the Aungel of oure lord appyeryd upon the gate holdyng the signe of the signe (*sic*) of the Crosse in his honde / and sayd / Whanne the Kynge of heven went to his passion by this gate / he was not arayed like a Kynge / ne on horsbake / but cam humbly upon an asse / in shewyng the example of humylite which he left to them that honoure hym. And when this was sayd / he departed and vanysshed awaye / Thenne th'emperour took of his hosen and shone³⁶ himself in wepyng / and despollyed hymselfe of alle his clothes in to his sherte / and tooke the crosse of oure lord / and bare it moche humbly into the gate / and anone the hardnes of the stones felte the celestyalle commaundement / and remeved anone / and opened and gaf entree unto them that entred / Thenne the sweete odour that was felt that day whanne the hooly Crosse was taken fro the Toure of Cosdroe / and was brought ageyne to Iherusalem fro so ferre countre / and so grete space of londe retourned in to Iherusalem in that moment / and replenysshed it with al swetnes / Thenne the ryght devoute Kyng beganne to saye the praysynge of the Crosse in this wyse / O Crux splendydior / et cetera / O Crosse more shynyng than alle the Sterres / honoured of the world / right holy / and moche amyable to alle men / whiche only were worthy to bere the raunson of the world Swete tree / Swete nayles / Swete yron / Swete spere beryng the swete burthens / Save thou this present company / that is this daye assembled in thy lawe and praysynge /. And thus was the precious tree of the Crosse re establysshed in his place / and the auncient myracles renewed /. For a dede man was reysed to lyf / and foure men taken with the palsey were cured and heled / ʒ lepres were made clene / and fyften blynde receyved theyr syghte ageyn / Devylles were put out of men / and moche peple / and many / were delyvered of dyverse sekenes and maladyes /. Thenne themperour dyd doo repayre the Chirches / and gaf to them grete

geftes / And after retorned home to his Empyre / And hit is said in the Cronycles that this was done otherwise / For they say that whanne Cosdroe hadde taken many Royammes / he took Iherusalem / and Zacharye the patriarke / and bare awaye the tree of the Crosse / And as Heracle wold make pees with hym / the Kyng Cosdroe swore a grete othe / that he wold never make pees with Crysten men and Romainys / yf they denyed not hym that was crucyfied / and adoured the sonne /. And thenne Heracle / whiche was armed wythe faythe / brought his hooste ageynst hym / and destroyed and wasted the Persyens with many batayles that he made to them / and made Cosdroe to flee unto the Cyte of thelyfonte /. And atte the laste Cosdroe hadde the flyxe in his bely / And wolde therefore crowne his sone Kyng / which was named Mendasa /. And whenne Syroys his oldest sone herde thereof he made alyance with Heracle / And pursewed his fader with his noble peple / and set hym in bondes / And susteyned him with breede of trybulacion / and with water of anguysshe / And atte last he made to shote arowes at him bycause he wold not bileve in god & so deyde / & after this thyng he sente to Heracle the patriarke the tree of the Crosse and all the prysoners / And Heracle bare into Iherusalem the precious tree of the Crosse /. And thus it is redde in many Cronycles also/. Sybyle sayth thus of the tre of the Crosse / that the blessyd tree of the Crosse was thre tymes with the paynymys / as it is sayd in thystorie trypertyte O thryse blessyd tree on whiche god was stratched / This peradventure is sayd for the lyf of Nature / of grace / and of glorie / which cam of the crosse /. At Constantynople a Iewe entyred in to the chirche of seynt sophye / and consydered that he was there allone / and sawe an ymage of Ihesu cryste / and tooke his swerde and smote thymage in the throte / and anone the bloode guysshed oute / and sprange in the face and on the hide of the Iewe / And he thenne was aferd and took thymage / and cast it into a pytte / and anone fledde away /. And it happed that a Crysten man mett hym / and sawe hym al bloody / and sayd to hym / fro whens comest thou / thou hast slayne soume man / And he sayd I have not / the crysten man sayd Veryly thou has commysed somme homycyde / for thou art all besprongen³⁷ with the blood. And the Jewe said / Veryly the god of Crysten men is grete and the faythe of hym is ferme and approved in all thynges / I have smyten no man / but I have smyten thymage of Ihesu Cryste / and anone yssued blood of his throte /. And thenne the Jewe brought the Crysten man to the pytte / and then they drewe oute that hooly ymage /. And yet is sene on this daye the wounde in

the throte of thymage / And the Iewe anone bycam a good Crysten man, & was baptysed / In Syre in the cyte of baruth there was a cristen man / which had hyred an hous for a yere / & he had set thymage of the crucifixe by his bedde to whiche he made dayly his prayers and said his devociions / & at the yeres ende he remeved and tooke another hous / & forgate & lefte thymage behynde hym / and it happed that a Iewe hyred that same hows / & on a daye he had another Iewe one of his neyghbours to dyne / & as they were at mete it happed hym that was boden³⁸ in lookyng on the walle to espye this ymage whiche was fyxed to the walle and beganne to grenne at it for despyte / and ageynst hym that bad hym / & also thretned & menaced hym bycause he durst kepe in his hous thymage of Ihesu of nazareth / & that other Iewe sware as moche as he myght / that he had never sene it / ne knewe not that it was there / & thenne the Iewe fayned as he had been peasyd³⁹. / & after went strait to the prynce of the Iewes / & accused that Iewe of that whiche he hadde sene in his hous / thenne the Iewes assembleden & cam to the hous of hym / & sawe thymage of Ihesu Cryst / and they took that Iewe and bete hym / & did to hym many iniuries / & caste hym out half dede of their synagoge / & anone they defowled thymage with their feet / & renewed in it all the tormentes of the passion of oure lorde / & and when they perced his syde with the spere / blood and water yssued haboundauntly / in so moche that they fylled a vessel / whiche they set therunder / And thenne the Iewes were abasshed & bare this blood in to theyr synagoge & and alle the seke men and malades that were enoynted therwyth / were anone guarysshed & made hool / & thenne the Iewes told & recounted al this thyng by ordre to the bishop of the countre / & alle they with one wyll receyved baptysm in the faythe of Ihesu Cryst / & the bisshop putt the blood in ampulles⁴⁰ of Crystalle & of glas for to be kepte / & thenne he called / the Crysten man that had lefte it in the hows / & enquired of hym / who had made so fayr an ymage / & he said that Nychodemus had made it / And when he deyde / he lefte it to gamalyel / And Gamalyel to Zachee and Zachee to Iaques / and Iaques to Symon / and hadde ben thus in Ierusalem unto the destruction of the Cyte / and fro thennes hit was borne in to the Royamme of Agryppe of Crysten men / and fro thennes hit was brought ageyne into my countre / & it was left to me by my parentes by rightful herytage / & this was done in y^e yere of our lord seven honderd and fifty / and thenne alle the Iewes halowed⁴¹ their synagogues in to chirches

and therof cometh the custoume that Chirches ben hallowed / For tofore that tyme the aultres were but halowed only / and for this myracle the chirche hath ordeyned / that the fyfte Kalendar of december / or as it is redde in another place / the fyfthe ydus of Novembre shold be the memorye of the passyon of oure lord / wherfor at Rome the chirche is halowed in thonoure of our savyour whereas is kepte an ampulla with the same blood / And there a solempne feste is kepte and done / and there is proved the ryght grete vertue of the crosse unto the paynymys and to the mysbylevyd men in alle thynges /.

And saynt Gregory recordeth in the thirdde booke of his dyalogues / that whanne andrewe Bisshop of the Cyte of Fundane suffred an holy nounge to dwelle with him / the fende⁴² thenemy beganne temprynte in his herte the beaulte of her / in such wise / that he thought in hys bedde wycked and cursyd thynges / and on a daye a Iewe cam to Rome / and whanne he sawe / that the day fayled / and myghte fynde no lodgyng / he wente that nyght / and abode in the Temple of appolyn /. And bycause he doubted of the sacrylege of the place / how be hit / that he hadde no faythe in the Crosse / yet he markyd and garnysshed hym wyth the signe of the Crosse / then at mydnyght whan he awoke / he sawe a companye of evylle sprytes / whiche went to fore one / like as he hadde somme auctoryte puyfiance⁴³ above thother by subiection / and thenne he sawe hym sytte in the myddes among the others / and beganne to enquire the causes and dedes of everyche⁴⁴ of these evylle sprytes / whyche obeyed hym / and he wold knowe / what evylle everyche had doo / But Gregory passyth the maner of this vysyon / bycause of shortnes / But we fynde semblable in the lyf of faders / That as a man entryd in a Temple of thydolles / he sawe the devylle syttyng / and all his meyny⁴⁵ aboute hym. And one of these wycked / sprytes cam / and adouryd hym / and he demaunded of hym / Fro whens comest thou / and he sayd / I have ben in such a provynce / and have moeved grete warres / and made many trybulacions and have shedde moche blood / and am come to telle it to the / and Sathan sayd to hym / in what

⁴²*Fiend.*

⁴³*Power.*

⁴⁴*Each or every one.*

⁴⁵*Attendants.*

⁴⁶*Drew.*

⁴⁷*Jest.*

⁴⁸*Kiss.*

⁴⁹*In this wise.*

tyme hath thou done this / and he sayd in thyrty dayes and Sathan sayd / why hast thou be soo longe there aboutes / and sayd to them that stode by hym / goo ye and bete hym / and all to lasshe hym / Thenne cam the second and worsshiped hym / & sayde Syre I have ben in the see / and have moeved grete wyndes and tormentes / & drowned many shippes / & slayn many men / and Sathan sayde how longe hast thou ben aboute thys / & he sayd ~~xxii~~ dayes / & Sathan sayd hast thou done no more in this tyme / & commanded that he shold be beten / and the third cam / & said / I have ben in a Cyte & have mevyd stryves and debate in a weddyng / and have shed moche blood / & have slayne the hosbond / & am come to telle the / & sathan sayd / in what time hast thou done this / & he said in ten dayes / & he sayd hast thou done no more in that time / & commanded them that were aboute hym to bete hym also / Thenne cam the fourth & sayd / I have ben in the wylderness fourty yere / and have laboured aboute a monke / & unnethe at the laste I have throwen & made hym falle in the synne of the flesshe / & when sathan herd that / he aroos fro his sete / & kyssed hym / & tooke hys crowne of his hede / & set it on his hede / & made hym to sytte with hym / & sayde / thou hast done a grete thyng / & hast laboured more / than all thother / and this may be the maner of the vysyon / that saynt gregorye leveth / whan eche had sayd / one sterte up in the myddle of them alle / & seyde he hadde mevid Andrewe ageynste the name / & had mevyd the fourth part of his fleshe agenst her in temptacion / & therto / y^t yesterday he drough⁴⁶ so moche his mynde on her / that in the hour of evensonge he gaf to her in Iapping⁴⁷ a busse⁴⁸ / & seid pleyndly y^t she must here it that he wold synne with her / thenne the mayster commanded hym that he shold perform y^t he had begonne / & for to make hym to synne he shold have a syngular Vyctory and reward among alle the other /. And thenne commaunded he that they shold goo loke who that was that laye in the Temple / And they wente / & loked / And anone they were ware / that he was marked with the signe of the crosse / And they levyng aferd escaped / and sayd / veryly this is an empty vessel / alas / alas / he is marked /. And with⁴⁹ thus wys alle the company of the wykked sprytes vanysshed away / And thenne the Iewe al amoevyd cam to the bisshop / and told to hym all by ordere what was happend / And whan the bisshoppe herd this / he wept strongly / and made to voyde all the wymmen oute of his hows / And thenne he baptysed the Iewe.

Seynt Gregory reherceth in his dyalogues that a nonne entryd into a gardyne / and sawe a letuse / and coveyted that / and forgate to make the signe of the Crosse / and bote⁵⁰ it glotonously / And anone fylle doune and was ravysshed of a devylle / And ther cam to her saint Equycyon[J] / And the devylle beganne to crye and to saye / What have I doo / I satte uppon a lettuse / and she cam / and bote me / and anone the devylle yssued oute by the commaundement of the holy man of god /. It is redde in thystorye Scolastyke / that the paynymys had peynted on a walle the armes of Serapis / And Theodosyen dide doo putt them oute / and made to be paynted in the same place the signe of the Crosse / And when the paynims & priestes of thydolles sawe that / anone they dyde them to be baptysed / sayenge / that it was gyven them to understonde of their olders / that those armes shold endure tyll / that suche a signe were made then / in whiche were lyf / And they have a lettre / of whiche they use / y^t they calle holy / & had a forme that they said it exposed and signyfied lyf perdurable.

⁵⁰Bit.

Thus endeth the exaltacion of the holy Crosse.

Having read these extracts from the Golden Legend, we shall be able to understand the accompanying illustrations, which represent some frescos of the fifteenth century, which formerly adorned the walls of the / Chapel of the Gild of the Holy Cross, at Stratford-upon-Avon; which stands close by New Place, Shakespeare's house. These frescos, alas! no longer exist, for, in 1804, the Chapel underwent considerable repair, during which, under the whitewash, were discovered traces of paint, and these, being scraped, a series illustrating the legend of the Cross was found in the chancel, which was built in 1450. In other parts of the Chapel were found representations of the Ressurrection, and the day of Judgment, St. George and the Dragon, and the death of St. Thomas a Becket, besides others.

Luckily, a gentleman from London, a Mr. Fisher, was then staying at Stratford-on-Avon, and he drew, and painted them—afterwards, in 1807, publishing them—and it is from his sketches that these illustrations are taken. The barbarians of Stratford hacked the plaster on which the Holy

Cross series was painted to bits, and whitewashed all the other paintings. It is presumed they still exist, for, when the Chapel was thoroughly restored in 1835, traces of the other pictures were visible under the whitewash.

These pictures of the Invention, and Exaltation, of the Holy Cross are especially interesting, not only on account of their age and artistic merit, but from the fact that they are of English work, and show the English idea of treating the subject. I have reproduced them all but two; one, the fight on the bridge over the Danube between Heraclius and the son of Chosroes, and the other representing Heraclius smiting off Chosroes' head.





Plate **A** represents the visit of the Queen of Sheba to Solomon. Her name was Balkis, and, in her legendary history, it is reported that Solomon, having heard of her riches and power, sent her a peremptory message to submit herself to his rule. She, dreading war with so potent a sovereign, sent an embassy to try and find out whether Solomon was as wise as he was represented to be. With this object she dressed five hundred boys as girls, and a like number of girls as boys, and, among other presents, sent a pearl, a diamond cut through in zigzags, and a crystal box; and she should be able to judge of his wisdom and power, if he could tell the boys from the girls, pierce the pearl, thread the diamond, and fill the goblet with water that came neither from the earth nor the sky.

Needless to say, Solomon passed through the ordeal triumphantly. He ordered silver basins to be brought, so that the ambassadors' suite might wash their hands after their long journey, and the boys were easily distinguished from the girls, for they dipped their hands only in the water,

whilst the girls tucked up their sleeves and washed their arms as well as their hands. Then he opened the box containing the pearl, diamond, and goblet, and, taking out the pearl, he applied his magic stone, Samur, or Schamir, which a raven had brought him, and which had the power of cleaving anything, and lo! the pearl was pierced; then he examined the diamond, which was so pierced that no thread could be passed through it; so he took a worm, and having placed a piece of silk in its mouth, it wriggled through, and the diamond was threaded. The next task was to fill the goblet, which he gave to a negro slave, and bade him mount a wild horse and gallop it till it streamed with sweat, and then to fill the goblet with it, thus fulfilling the imposed conditions. He then gave back these presents to the ambassadors, who speedily returned to Queen Balkis. She at once saw that it would be useless to oppose the powerful will of Solomon, and immediately set out on her journey to that monarch.

It is here that her connection with the holy Cross comes in, for its wood, which Solomon had cut down in order to incorporate it into his Temple, and which had the inconvenient property of fitting in nowhere, being either too long or too short for any purpose, was in consequence thrown aside, and ultimately was used as a foot-bridge across a brook. Across this plank the Queen had to pass, but she, recognising its holy virtue, refused to walk across it, preferring to wade the brook, which, having done, she expounded its value to Solomon, and prophesied that out of it should be made the Cross on which Jesus should suffer.

She afterwards became one of Solomon's wives, and bore him a son, and then returned to her own land, and from this son are descended the kings of Abyssynia.

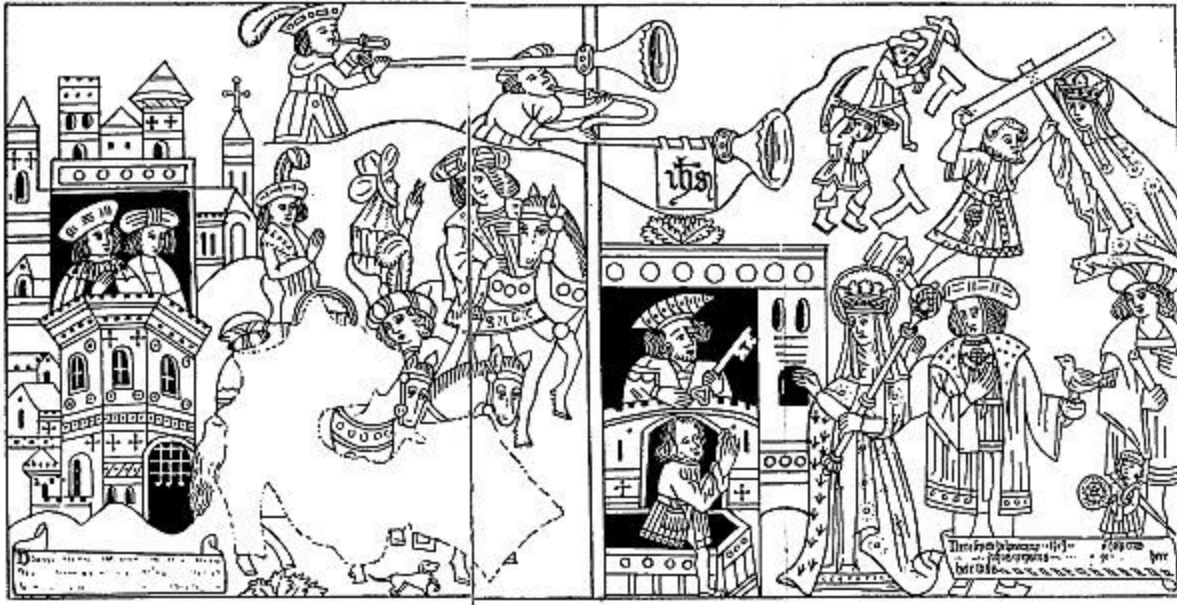
The legend on the label is, as far as is legible, REGINA SABA FAMA SALOMONIS (adduct) A VENIT (Iero)SOLUMA UBI LIGNUM IN . . . ABATICA . . . IT . . . GENIS . . . PERSOLVETUR.



Plate **B** is, virtually, two; one showing the angel appearing to Constantine when, early in the fourth century, he was advancing towards Rome against Maxentius; but the legend of the miraculous inscription which appeared in the sky, “IN HOC SIGNO VINCES,” does not appear. The other, and larger portion, represents his victory over Maxentius, and he is represented as spearing and killing that monarch; but this is not historically correct, for, after his defeat, as Maxentius fled towards Rome, essaying to cross the Tiber over a rotten bridge, it gave way, and he was drowned. It is noticeable that the Christian flag bears the Tau Cross.

C

D



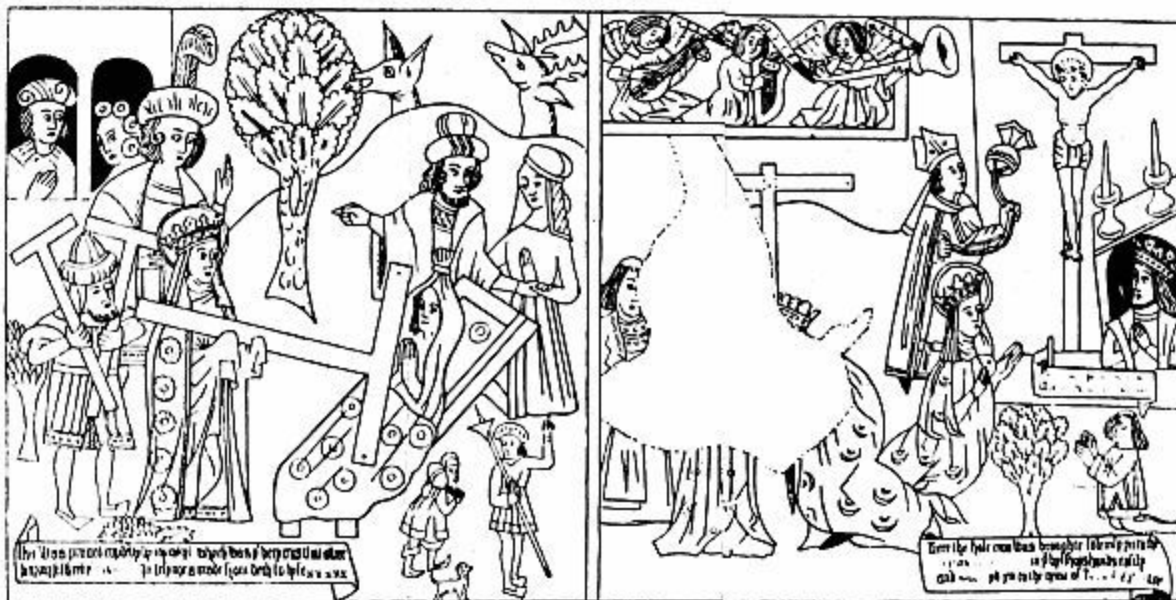
The Plates **C** and **D** run into each other, although they portray different subjects, **C** being the departure of St. Helena for Jerusalem on her quest of the holy Cross. The label in this fresco is utterly illegible.

Plate **D** shows Judas (called Julius in the label) Cyryacus (the Quiryache of the Golden Legend) being released, after having been forced, through imprisonment and starvation, into confessing where the holy Cross lay buried. In the upper part St. Helena is receiving the holy Cross, whilst labourers are uncovering the Tau Crosses of the two thieves.

The legend is mutilated, but enough remains to make its meaning clear:
 “HERE SEYNTE HELYNE EXAMY(neth) THE I(ews for) Y^E HOLY CROS IULIUS
 CYRYACUS (saith that he knew w)HERE HETE WAS.”

E

F



The legend in Plate **E** is nearly perfect, and accurately describes the painting, “HYT WAS PROVED EVIDENTLY BY MYRAKEL WHICH WAS Y^E VERY CROS THAT OURE SAVYOUR SUFFYRED IN RESYNGE A MADE FROM DETH TO LYFE.”

Here all the Crosses are of the Tau type, and the scene is laid in a forest, where an old labourer, and a bill-man, and the deer nibbling the trees, give a rural aspect, instead of in the City of Jerusalem, as saith the Golden Legend.

Plate **F** evidently consists of two separate paintings—one, where St. Helena is reverently carrying the Cross into Jerusalem, whilst the angels in heaven are discoursing celestial music; and the other, its reception either in Jerusalem or Byzantium, whither St. Helena sent a portion as a present to her son. And this latter seems the more probable, if we imagine the King, who, with St. Helena, is adoring the Crucifix, to be the emperor Constantine, a fact which might have been settled had the label been legible.

The legend at the bottom is unfortunately mutilated, but that evidently relates to that portion of the Cross which remained at Jerusalem, because it speaks of Chosroes: “HERE THE HOLE CROS WAS BROUGHTE SOLEMPLY YN TO THE . . . IN Y^E BYSSHOPS HANDS EASILY AND (remaynyd) UN TO THE TYME OF (King Codsd)ROE.



Plates **G** and **H** represent the story told in the Golden Legend, of Heraclius bearing the Cross into Jerusalem, how the gate miraculously closed, and an angel appeared in the heavens and reproved Heraclius for riding in state on the very spot where Jesus had gone in all meekness, and lowliness, to His passion. The legend is erased in parts, the unmutilated portion reading, “AS THE NOBUL KYNGE ERACLIVS COM RYDYNG TOWARDE Y^E CYTTE OF IERUSALEM BERYNG Y^E CROSSE SO GRETE PRYDE . . . WHERE Y^E”

Naturally, the possession of a piece of the true Cross would be esteemed as a most precious property. No matter how small, it would be reverentially enclosed in crystal and gold, and was more than a present fit for an emperor

or king, and we cannot marvel that small pieces were distributed all over Christendom. Possibly some of the relics shown as pieces of the very Cross might not have been what they were supposed to be, but it is hard to believe what John Calvin[K] wrote about it:—

“And fyrst of all let us begynne to speake of his crosse, whereupon he was hanged. I know that it is holden for a certaintie that it was founde of Helene the mother of Constantine the Romaine Emperour. I knowe also what certaine Doctours have written touching the approbation hereof, for to certifie that the crosse which she found was without doute the selfe same on the whiche Iesus Christ was hanged. Touchynge all this I reporte me to the thyng it selfe, so much is there that it was but a folish curiositie of her, or at the least a folishe and unconsidered devotion. But yet put the case it had ben a worke worthy of prayse to her, for to have taken paynes to fynde the trewe crosse, and that our lord had then declared by myracle that it was his crosse which she found; Yet let us onely consider that which is of our time. Every one doeth holde that this crosse which Helene founde is yet at Ierusalem, and none doeth doute thereof. Although the Ecclesiasticall history against sayeth the same notablie. For it is ther recited that Helene toke one part thereof to send to the Emperour her sonne, who put the same at Constantinople upon a fyne pyller of Marble in the myddest of the market. Of the other part, it is sayde that she did locke the same in a copher of silver, and gave it to the Bishop of Ierusalem to kepe. So then eyther we shall augment the historie of a lie or els that which is holden at this daye of the true Crosse, is but a vayne and triflyng opinion.

“Let us consider on the other part howe many peeces there are thereof throug out the worlde. Yf I would onely recite that whiche I coulde say there woulde be a register sufficient to fyl a whole boke. There is not so little a town where there is not some peece thereof, and that not onelye in cathedrall churches, but also in some parishes. Likewise ther is not so wicked an abbey where there is not of it to be shewed. And in some places ther are good great shydes:⁵¹ as at the holye chappell of Paris, and at Poitiers & at Rome, where there is a great crucifix made thereof as men saye. To be short, yf a man woulde gather together all that hath bene founde of this crosse, there would be inough to fraughte a great ship. The Gospell testifieth that the crosse myght be caried of one man. What audacitie then was this to fyll the earth with

⁵¹*Blocks—billets*

pieces of woad in such quantity, that three hundred men can not carry them,” &c.

Calvin was full of zeal, and could not stoop to particularise. Witness his assertion that the Cross would freight a ship, and yet that three hundred men could carry it. M. Rohault de Fleury has gone very minutely into this matter. Knowing, from microscopical examination, that several of the relics of the Cross were of pine, he accepts this wood as his basis, and, from its probable size, he deduces a weight of 100 kilogrammes, equal to about 240 English lbs.; and, taking the average density of pine, he estimates that this would give 178 millions of cubic millimetres. He then describes all the known pieces in Europe, Jerusalem, and Mount Athos, with their measurements, and he puts the outcome at 3,941,975 cubic millimetres; thus, according to his shewing, there is but a very small portion of the Holy Cross in existence. I subjoin his list of the places in which pieces of the Cross are known to exist, as it is most interesting, showing the comparative bulk of the pieces, in cubic millimetres:—

Aix la Chapelle	150
Amiens	4,500
Angers	2,640
Angleterre	30,516
Arles	8,000
Arras	10,314
Athos (le Mont)	878,360
Autun	50
Avignon	220
Baugé	104,000
Bernay	375
Besançon	1,000
Bologne	15,000
Bonifacio	47,960
Bordeaux	3,420
Bourbon l'Archambault	29,275
Bourges	22,275
Bruxelles	516,090

Chalmarques	”
Châlons	200
Chamirey	605
Chatillon	”
Cheffes (Anjou)	100
Chelles	”
Compiègne	1,896
Conques	108
Cortone	3,000
Courtrai	200
Dijon	33,091
Donawert	12,000
Faghine	”
Florence	37,640
Fumes	5,250
Gand	436,450
Gênes	26,458
Gramont	5,000
Jancourt (Aube)	3,500
Jerusalem	5,045
Langres	200
Laon	”
Libourne	3,000
Lille	15,112
Limbourg	133,768
Longpont	1,136
Lorris	”
Lyon	1,696
Mâcon	2,000
Maestricht	10,000
Marseille	150
Milan	1,920
Montepulciano	500
Naples	10,000

Nevers	176
Nuremberg	”
Padoue	64
Paris	237,731
Pisa	8,175
Poitiers	870
Pontigny	12,000
Raguse	169,324
Riel les Eaux	671
Rome	537,587
Royaumont	”
Saint Dié	99
Saint Florent	400
Saint Quentin	5,000
Saint Sepolcro	200
Sens	69,545
Sienna	1,680
Tournai	2,000
Trèves	18,000
Troyes	201
Turin	6,500
Venice	445,582
Venloo	”
Walcourt	2,000
Wambach	”
TOTAL	<u>3,941,975</u>

According to this table we are credited in England with 30,516 cubic millimetres of the holy Cross, and it is interesting to know where they are situated. M. Rohault de Fleury, writing in 1870, says there were pieces at Isleworth; St. Gregory, Downside, near Bath; in the possession of Lord Petre; at Bergholt East, in Suffolk; at Plowden; at the convent of St. Mary, York; at West Grinstead; at St. George's, Southwark; and Slindon, Sussex.

These pieces of the holy Cross are not large, as the following table, in cubic millimetres, shows:—

At Isleworth	1,000
” College of St. Gregory	6,120
Lord Petre (two relics)	8,287
At St. Mary, Bergholt East	1,008
” Plowden Hall, Salop	262
” St. Mary, York (two relics)	5,600
” West Grinstead ”	38
” St. George’s, Southwark (four relics)	63
” St. Richard, Slindon	<u>8,100</u>
TOTAL	30,516

One relic at St. Mary’s Convent, York, is very fine; it is ornamented with scroll-work of the tenth century, and bears three impressions of the seal of the Vicar Capitular of the diocese of Saint Omer, 1657 to 1662. It is a pectoral cross that is supposed to have belonged to the patriarch Arnulph, who was with Robert, Duke of Normandy.

The other is supposed to have been attached to the above, and to have belonged equally to Arnulph, patriarch of Jerusalem. This is kept in a silver reliquary, which also contains relics of SS. Ignatius Loyola and François Xavier.

We see by the Golden Legend, that St. Helena, after finding the Cross, feeling certain that the nails were not far off, prosecuted a further search for them, and they were discovered “shynyng as gold.” As with the fashion of the Cross, whether it was *immissa* or *commissa*, there is, and was, a controversy with regard to the nails, whether three or four.

Bosius in his learned and exhaustive book, *Crux Triumphans et Gloriosa*,[\[L\]](#) gives several authorities for three nails only—foremost, Gregory Nazianzen; but he does not give the passage where it may be found; the quotation, however, is

Γυμνὸν τρισήλω κείμενον ξύλῳ λαβών

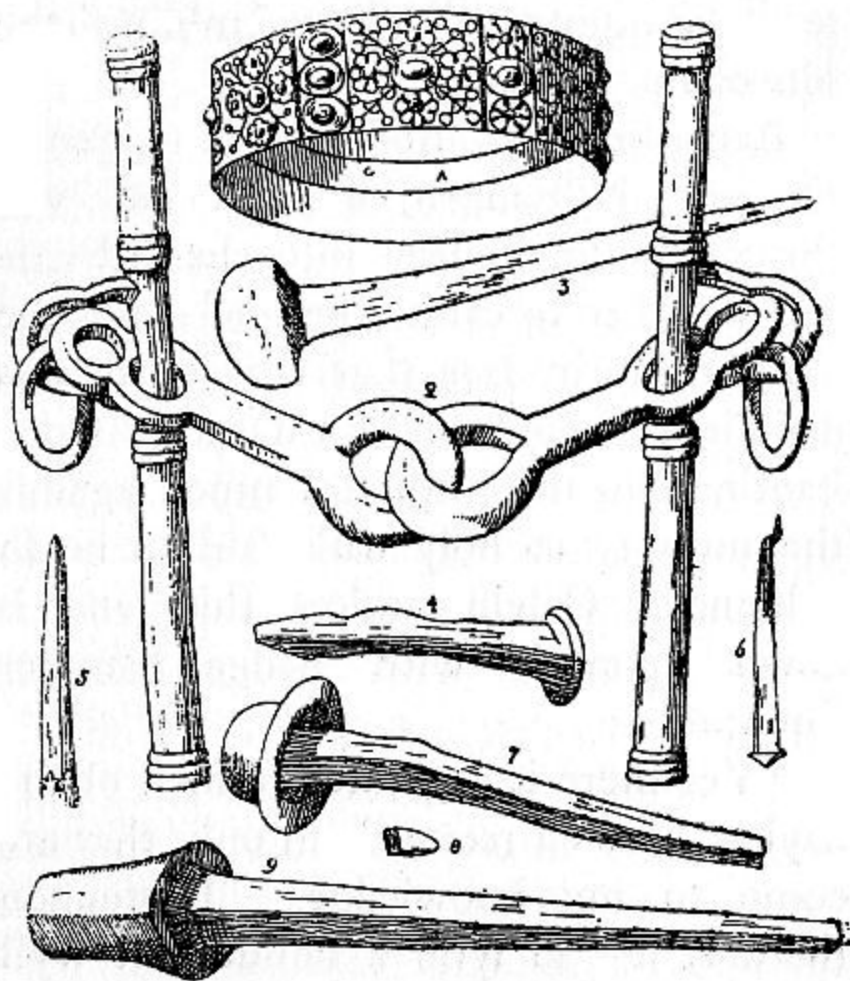
“having taken from the three-nailed wood the dead (or hanging) body.” Thus clearly showing the number of nails he considered right.

Bosius then goes on to quote Apollinaris Laodicensis, who, in his tragedy entitled *Christus patiens*, called the holy Cross by the same words, τρισηλον ξυλω, “three-nailed wood”; and he also quotes from the *Meditat. vitæ Christi* of Bonaventura, “*Illi tres clavi sustinent totius corporis pondus.*” Nonnus, the Greek poet, writing in the fifth century, also says that our Lord’s feet overlapped each other, and were fastened by only one large nail. So that there is a very fair amount of antiquity in favour of three nails.

Against this theory may be quoted the authority of St. Cyprian, St. Augustine, St. Gregory of Tours, Pope Innocent III., Rufinus, Theodoret, and others, who say four nails were used in the Crucifixion of our Saviour. The battle waged pictorially; but perhaps the earliest known representation of the Crucifixion, that found in the Cemetery of St. Julian, Pope, or of St. Valentine in Via Flaminia at Rome, ought to bear most weight. Our Saviour is represented as being clothed in a long sleeveless robe, which reaches to His ankles; the feet are separate, and are each nailed. It is said that Cimabue was the first to paint the feet overlapping, and one nail. His example, however, was much followed, and hence the controversy.

Of these nails, universal tradition says that St. Helena sent two to her son Constantine, and, as the Golden Legend has it, “the emperour dyd do sette them in hys brydel and in hys helme when he wente to batayle.” One can understand one of these sacred nails being worn in the Emperour’s helmet as a presage of victory and as a safeguard against danger, but the utility of incorporating one of such priceless relics in a horse’s bridle is not so easy to comprehend; but the fathers of the Church, St. Cyril of Alexandria, St. Ambrose, Theodoret, and St. Gregory of Tours, recognise in it the fulfilment of the prophecy of Zecharias, chap. xiv. 20: “In that day shall be upon the bridles of the horses, HOLINESS UNTO THE LORD.”

This bridle, or rather bit, is now said to be in existence in France at Carpentras, department of Vaucluse. How it got there is not clearly known, but probably it was taken at the time of the Crusades—as leaden seals on which it is engraved exist, attached to parchments of the dates 1226 and 1250, and it was mentioned in an inventory of relics in the year 1322.



¹ The iron crown of Lombardy. ² The holy bridle at Carpentras. ³ Nail at Venice. ⁴ Nail at Rome in Sta. Maria in Campitelli. ⁵ Nail at Arras. ⁶ Nail at Colle. ⁷ Nail in the Church of the Holy Cross of Jerusalem, at Rome. ⁸ Portion of nail at Toul. ⁹ Nail at Trèves.

I have reproduced it, as well as the Iron Crown of Lombardy and the nails, from M. Rohault de Fleury's work, and, as will be seen, it is undoubtedly of great antiquity, closely resembling the bits of the Romans.

According to Bosius, who quotes Gregory Nazianzen, a third nail was thrown by St. Helena into the Adriatic Sea, in order to calm a tempest; and the same authority says that the fourth was deposited in the head of a statue of Constantine, but this militates much against the number of holy nails said to be in existence. Calvin notices this, and is down upon it with sledge-hammer force:—

“Yet there is a greater combat of the nayles. I wyll recite them only that are come to my knowledge. Thereupon there is not so lytle a childe but wyll judge that the Devyll hath to much deluded the worlde in takyng from it both understandyng and reason, that it coulde discerne nothyng in this matter. If the auncient writers saye trewe, and namely Theodorite Historiographer of the auncient church, Helene caused one to be nayled on her sonne’s helmet, the other two she put in his horse bitte. How be it Saint Ambrose sayeth not fully so. For he sayeth that one was put in Constantine’s crowne, of the other his horsebit was made, and the thirde Helene kept. Wee se y^t already more than twelve hundred yeres agoe this hath bene in controversie, to wit, what was become of the nayles. What certentie can be had of them then at this present time?

“Now at Millan they boste that thei have y nayle that was put in Constantine’s horse bitte. To the whiche the towne of Carpentras opposeth herselfe, sayinge that it is she that hath it. Nowe S. Ambrose doth not saye that the nayle was knit to the bitte, but that the bitte was made thereof. Whiche thyng can in no wyse be made to agre eyther w^t their saying of Milan or w^t theirs of Carpentras.

“Moreover there is one in Rome at Saint Helenes; another also at Sene, another at Venise. In Germany two: at Collyne one, at the three Maries: another at Triers, one in Fraunce at the holy chappell of Paris, another at y^e Carmes, one also at Saint Denis in France: one at Burges: one at Tenaill, one at Dragaine.

“Beholde here fourteene, whereof account is made; in every place they alledge good approbation for themselves, as they suppose. And so it is that everye one hath as good right as aunother. Wherefor there is no better way then to make them all passe under one fidelium. That is to saye, to repute all that they saye hereof to be but lyes, seying that otherwise a man shoulde never come to an ende.”

What would Calvin have said if he had seen the formidable list of holy nails enumerated by Guisto (or Justus) Fontanini, Archbishop of Ancyra? which is as follows:—

1. Aix la Chapelle.

2. Ancona, in the Cathedral.
3. Bamberg.
4. In Bavaria, Convent of Audechsen.
5. Carpentras. The Holy Bit.
6. Catania, Sicily.
7. Colle, in Tuscany.
8. Cologne.
9. The Escorial in Spain.
10. Milan.
11. Monza. The Iron Crown.
12. Naples. Monastery of S. Patricius.
13. Nuremberg. Church of the Holy Virgin.
14. Paris.
15. Rome. Two Nails. Church of the Holy Cross of Jerusalem; Church of Santa Maria in Campitelli.
16. Sienna. Hospital Sainte Marie de de l'Echelle.
17. Spoleto.
18. Torcello, near Venice. Church of S. Anthony.
19. Torno, on the Lake of Como.
20. Toul.
21. Trèves.
22. Venice. Three nails.
23. Vienna.

But this list is further supplemented by M. Rohault de Fleury, who gives six more:—

1. Arras, according to M. le Chev. de Linas.
2. Compiègne. A point.
3. Cracow, in Poland, according to M. Gosselin.
4. Florence.
5. Lagny.
6. Troyes.

So that no less than twenty-nine towns claim the possession of thirty-two nails, all differing in form, the number of which can only be accounted for

by the supposition that only a portion of the holy nails has been incorporated into each of them.



The Title of the Cross.

One of the most interesting relics in connection with the holy nails is the Iron Crown of Lombardy. This, as may be seen by reference to the illustration (Fig. 1), is a circlet of gold, ornamented with precious stones, and it is indebted for its name of “Iron” to a thin band (**A**) of that metal, which is inside the gold circlet. The Crown itself is of very antique form, being even devoid of rays, and is too small to go on the head. Charlemagne was crowned with it in 774, and Napoleon did not think himself King of Italy until he had placed this precious diadem on his head, in 1805. It is kept at Monza, nine miles from Milan, in the Cathedral, which is of great antiquity. There it reposes in a huge cross placed over the altar.

Of the relics of the Cross there now remains but two specks of the title or inscription thereon, and here, again, I am indebted to M. Rohault de Fleury for the illustration on page xciv., as it seems to me to be the best yet published.

The Evangelists, although agreeing in the spirit of the inscription, vary as to the letter.

Says St. Matthew: “This is Jesus the King of the Jews.”

“ St. Mark: ”The King of the Jews.“

” St. Luke: “This is the King of the Jews.”

“ St. John: ”Jesus of Nazareth the King of the Jews.“

Neither St. Matthew nor St. Mark note the tri-lingual character, and SS. Luke and John vary as to the order of the different languages; the former saying it was in Greek, Latin, and Hebrew—the latter that it was in Hebrew, Greek, and Latin. The latter is the generally accepted form, and the reason given is, that Hebrew, being the common language, it would naturally come first, as we should do in an English notice, first in English, then, say in French and German, for the benefit of foreigners, as were the Greeks and Romans in Jerusalem.

The tradition is that, along with the Cross, St. Helena found the inscription, and that she sent it, together with a piece of the Holy Cross and a number of other sacred relics, to Rome, where it was deposited in the basilica of Santa Croce. Here it remained until Valentinian, fearing that it might fall into the hands of the Goths and Huns, hid it in the wall of the building, until it was found in 1492.

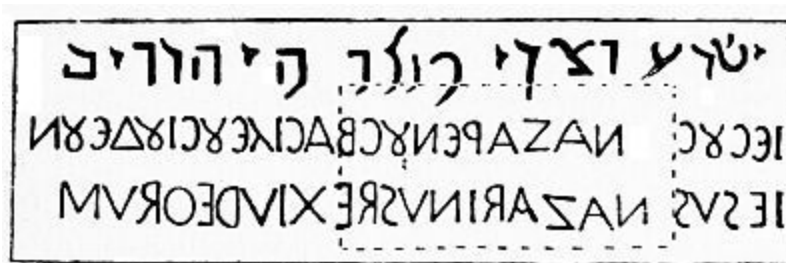
Valentinian died A.D. 375, and Antoninus Martyr, in his *De Locis Sanctis* (sec. 20), written about A.D. 570, says he saw the inscription which had been placed on the Cross, and that the words were, “Iesus Nazarenus Rex Iudæorum.” He says that he held it in his hand, and kissed it, in the Church of Constantine at *Jerusalem*. Hence it is evident that either tradition is incorrect, or that Antoninus did not tell the truth.

But the claim is that it is, and always has been, in Rome, and Bosius, in his *Crux Triumphans* (p. 60), gives an account of its re-discovery. He says that in February, 1492, Monseigneur Pedro Gonsalvo de Mendoza, Cardinal Sanctæ Crucis, was repairing and cleansing his church, and on the first day of that month, when the workmen reached the top of the arch which was in the middle of the basilica, and near the roof, they saw two small columns; and finding a space, they discovered a niche in which they found a leaden box, well closed, and on its lid was a tablet of marble, on which were engraved these words: HIC EST TITVLVS VERÆ CRUCIS. In this box was found a little board, about a hand’s breadth and a half, much corroded on one side by time, and bearing, in grooved, engraved characters, which were coloured red, the following inscription: IESVS NAZARENVS REX IVDÆORVM. But the

word IVDÆORVM was not entire, the last two letters VM having crumbled to pieces by reason of old age. The first line was written in Latin characters, the second in Greek, and the third in Hebrew.

All the city went to see it; and three days afterwards, Pope Innocent went also, and ordered the relic to be preserved in its box, and covered with a sheet of glass. Every one was convinced that they had before their eyes the inscription which Pilate placed upon the Cross over our Saviour's head, and which Saint Helena had deposited in the church at the time of its building.

The relic, as now seen, is very worm-eaten, but the letters are still visible, and have been cut with a small gouge. They read from right to left, as Hebrew does, thus lending great plausibility to the idea that it was done by some Jewish artificers; and it seems to be of some close-grained wood. Taking the piece now at Santa Croce, the whole inscription, if restored, would be thus:



The Inscription at Santa Croce, restored.





Notes on the Woodcuts.



THE History of the Legend of the Holy Cross which is here reproduced, is somewhat fuller than the Golden Legend of Caxton, there being particulars about Moses, David, and Solomon not to be found therein; but they may be found in other versions of the Legend, some in the Latin of Jacobus de Voragine, others in two MSS. in the British Museum.[\[M\]](#)

The engravings are taken from a very rare book, of which, as far as is known, there are but three copies in existence: one is in the Royal Library at Brussels, another at the Hague, in the collection of Mr. Schinkel, and the third is in the possession of Lord Spencer at Althorp. It is from this book that these fac-similes (made by M. J. Ph. Berjeau) were taken. The book itself has one woodcut on each page, with a verse in Dutch, at the bottom, explanatory of each engraving. It is called indifferently *Historia Sanctæ Crucis* or *Boec van den houte* (Book of the wood or tree).

It was printed at Kuilenburg on March 6th, 1483, by John Veldener,[\[N\]](#) who had just removed from Louvain. These sixty-four engravings were originally on thirty-two blocks,[\[O\]](#) and evidently belonged to some much older block book, now lost. These, Veldener cut in half, as he had already treated a *Speculum*, and brought them out as a fresh book.

The Legend as told by these engravings is as follows:—

Adam, feeling himself about to die, sent Seth to Paradise to beg for some of the oil of mercy,¹ which, however, the Archangel Michael refused to give him, but, instead, presented him with three seeds of the tree of life.² On his return, he found Adam dead, and, being unable to administer these seeds to his father in any other manner, he put them under his tongue, and then

Woodcut [No. 1.](#)

[No. 2.](#)

[No. 3.](#)

buried him.³ Presently these seeds germinated and shot through the ground, and are traditionally said to have been a cedar, a cypress, and a pine.⁴ They grew until Moses had led the Israelites out of Egypt, when he found them in the Valley of Hebron, and he recognized them as typifying the Trinity. He removed them, and they were his constant companions.⁵ With them he smote the rock, and the waters gushed out,⁶ and the bitter waters of Marah became sweet.^{7, 8}

[No. 4.](#)

[No. 5.](#)

[No. 6.](#)

[Nos. 7, 8.](#)

He then planted them in the land of Moab,⁹ and there they remained, until an angelic vision appeared unto David, and commanded him to go, and take them up, and bring them to Jerusalem.¹⁰ On his return the three rods worked miracles, healing the sick,¹¹ and the leprous, with a touch;¹² nay, more, on being applied to three black men, they instantly became white.¹³

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Arrived at Jerusalem, they wished to plant them, but for the night they left them in a cistern, by the Tower of David,¹⁴ and lo! during the night, they struck root, and, entwining themselves, became but one stem,¹⁵ which, when David saw, he had a wall built round it.¹⁶ And the tree grew for thirty years, David ornamenting it with rings of sapphire and other precious stones, adding one for every year, and under this tree he composed the Psalms, and praised God exceedingly.¹⁷

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But Solomon, who must needs have all that was rare and costly to adorn his temple, cast his eyes upon this precious tree, and ordered it to be cut down.¹⁸ It was duly felled, and squared, and trimmed, and it measured thirty cubits in length.¹⁹ But when the carpenters came to put it into a place of that length, it was a cubit too short, and when it was fitted into a place of twenty-nine cubits, lo! it measured thirty, and the carpenters marvelled much, and were

greatly astonished, and so, being useless, it was laid aside.²⁰ Yet the people came to see this wonderful tree, and amongst them was a maid named Maximilla, who sat down upon it, and instantly her clothes were in a blaze.²¹ Then she began to lift up her voice, and prophesy, crying, “My God, and my Lord Jesu Christ.”²² Then the Jews took her, and scourged her to death.²³

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The Jews, not knowing what to do with this miraculous tree, laid it across a brook,²⁴ and, when the Queen of Sheba came to visit Solomon, she recognized the virtue of the wood; and, refusing to defile it with her feet, she dismounted, and adored it, and waded through the brook.²⁵ Then, when she met Solomon, she reproved him, and told him that on that tree would the Saviour of the world suffer death.²⁶ And Solomon commanded the holy wood to be taken up,²⁷ and caused it to be carried into the Temple, there to be placed over the door, so that all men might bless, and adore it, and he coated it over with gold and silver.²⁸ There it remained until Abias stripped it of its costly coverings,²⁹ and the Jews buried it deep in the earth.³⁰

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There it remained for many years, until the Jews wished to make a pool, where the priests might wash the beasts, to purify them, previous to sacrificing them, and, unknowingly, they dug over the burial-place of the Holy Cross.³¹ This imparted such a virtue to the water of that pool, which was called Bethesda, that the sick were healed thereat, and an angel at times descended from heaven, and stirred the waters, and then whoever could get first into the waters was straightway healed of any infirmity he might have.³²

[No. 31.](#)

[No. 32.](#)

We now come to the Crucifixion, and there was a lack of wood to make Christ’s cross—when, suddenly, from the depths of Bethesda, leaped up the tree of the

[No. 33.](#)

Cross, and floated gently to land. One ran to the High Priest,³³ and told him of the timely find of suitable wood, and he at once gave orders for it to be fashioned into a Cross.³⁴ Then comes the mournful procession to Calvary, with our Saviour fainting under the weight of the Cross, and Simon the Cyrenean is pressed into the service to help Jesus.³⁵ And then the Crucifixion.³⁶

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And whilst the crosses were still standing, the disciples came to them and prayed, and many were healed of their infirmities, and many devils were cast out.³⁷ This so angered the Jews that they took the crosses down, and buried them,³⁸ and there they remained until their invention by St. Helena, A.D. 326. On her arrival at Jerusalem,³⁹ she convened a meeting of the principal Jews, and they denied all knowledge of it, but, on threat of being burnt, they said that one of their number, named Judas, knew where the crosses were buried.⁴⁰ Judas, however, refused to tell, and, to compel him to impart his knowledge, St. Helena had him lowered into a dry well, “and there tormented hym by hongre and evyl reste.”⁴¹ Seven days of this treatment made him submissive, and at the end of that time he capitulated. He was then drawn up,⁴² and prayed to God to direct him to the right spot.⁴³ His prayer was heard, and after some digging, the crosses were discovered.⁴⁴

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The news was brought to St. Helena, who visited the spot,⁴⁵ but although there were certainly three crosses, no one knew which was the one upon which Jesus suffered. A test, however, was applied, which proved to be satisfactory. The body of a maid was being borne on a bier for burial, but the funeral procession was stopped, and the body was touched by the different crosses. The two first produced no effect,⁴⁶ but when the third touched the dead maiden, she was at once restored to

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life.⁴⁷ Here, then, was proof positive; this was the very Cross; and St. Helena, mindful of her son Constantine, divided the sacred wood; part she enclosed in a case of precious metal, and kept at Jerusalem;⁴⁸ and part she sent to her son, at Byzantium, who received it with due reverence,⁴⁹ and deposited it in the church, with great ceremony.⁵⁰

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Here it remained, until it was taken away, with other spoil, by Chosroes, the King of Persia, who, aware of the sanctity of the relic, had it placed on the right hand of his throne. He was so puffed up with pride, that he ordered himself to be adored. His people, hitherto, had worshipped the sun, but now he ordained that henceforth he was to be considered the principal Person in the Trinity (the Father), and that the relic of the Cross was to be looked upon as the Son, whilst a golden cock which he had made was to represent the Holy Ghost.⁵¹

[No. 51.](#)

Then Heraclius made war against Chosroes, and meeting with a Persian army under one of the sons of that monarch, it was agreed that, in order to prevent a useless effusion of blood, the two commanders should fight it out between them, and whoever was vanquished should submit.⁵² The duel was fought on a bridge over the Danube, and Heraclius vanquished and killed the son of Chosroes.⁵³ The Persian army then made their submission,⁵⁴ and the penance imposed upon them by the conqueror was that they should all be baptized, which was duly done.

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Heraclius then went to Chosroes, and told him what he had done, offering him his life if he too would embrace Christianity,⁵⁵ but the Persian monarch refused, and Heraclius smote off his head.⁵⁶ He then crowned a son of Chosroes, and caused him to be baptized,⁵⁷ himself standing sponsor, and buried the slain king with befitting honours.⁵⁸ Then, taking possession of the holy relic,⁵⁹ he set out with it for Jerusalem. But, as he was bearing it in great state, he came to that gate of the City through which

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Jesus went to His passion, worn, buffeted, scorned, and weary, carrying the heavy burden of His cross. And suddenly the gateway became solid masonry, so that he could not pass through, and an angel appeared in the heavens, and reproved him for his ostentatious display in a place which his Saviour had previously trodden in such deep humility.⁶⁰ Heraclius dismounted from his horse, and, stripping himself of all the trappings of royalty, barefoot, and in his shirt,⁶¹ he meekly bore the Cross to its appointed place,⁶² the masonry disappearing as soon as he had humbled himself.

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A piece of the Cross was afterwards sent to Rome, where it duly arrived after a very stormy voyage,⁶³ and it was there preserved for the adoration of the faithful.⁶⁴

[No. 63.](#)

[No. 64.](#)

JOHN ASHTON.



FOOTNOTES:

[A]“And for as moche as this sayd worke was grete & over chargeable to me taccomplishe, I feryd me in the begynnyng of the translacion to have contynued it / bycause of the longe tyme of the translacion / & also in thenpryntyng of y^e same and in maner halfe desperate to have accomplisshd it / was in purpose to have lefte it / after that I had begonne to translate it / & to have

layed it aparte ne had it be(en) at thynstance & requeste of the puyssant noble & vertuous erle my lord wyllyam erle of arondel / whych desyred me to procede & contynue the said werke / & promysed me to take a resonable quantyte of them when they were acheyeued & accomplisshed / and sente to me a worshypful gentylman a servaunt of his named John Stanney which solycyted me in my Lordes name that I shold in no wyse leve it but accomplishe it promysyng that my sayd lord shold duringe my lyf geve & graunt to me a yerely fee / that is to wete a bucke in sommer / & a doo in Wynter / with whiche fee I holde me wel contente,” &c.

[B]This apparently long life of Adam is admitted on all hands, even in the Revised Version of the Bible. The Talmud says that God promised him one thousand years of life, and it is recorded that he begat Seth when he was a hundred and thirty years old. On this the Talmud (*Eruvin*, fol. 18, col. 2) has the following comment: “Rav Yirmyah ben Elazer said: All those years, which Adam spent in alienation from God, he begat evil spirits, demons, and fairies; for it is said, ‘And Adam was an hundred and thirty years, and begat a son in his own likeness, after his image’; consequently, before that time, he begat after another image.”

*Length of
Adam's life.*

This term of one hundred and thirty years seems to have been a period in Adam's existence, for we again find (*Eruvin*, fol. 18 b.): “Adam was a Chasid, or great saint, when he observed that the decree of death was occasioned by him; he *fasted* a hundred and thirty years, and all this time he abstained from intercourse with his wife.”

There is a Talmudical tradition that God showed the future to Adam (Avoth d'Rab. Nathan, chap. 31): “The Holy One—blessed be He!—shewed unto Adam each generation, and its preachers, its guardians, its leaders, its prophets, its heroes, its sinners, and its saints, saying, ‘In such and such a generation such and such a *King* shall reign, in such and such a generation such and such a wife man shall teach.’” This is amplified in Midrash Yalkut (fol. 12), where it is said that God showed Adam all future generations of men, with their leaders, learned and literary men, and there he observed that David was credited with only three hours of life, and he said, “Lord and Creator of the world, is this unalterable?” “Such was my first intention,” was the reply. “How many years have I to live?” asked Adam. “One thousand.” Then Adam said, “I will lend him some of my years.” And a document was drawn up whereby Adam transferred seventy years of his life to David.

*Talmud legends
respecting
Adam's length
of life.*

S. Baring-Gould, in his legends of *Old Testament Characters*, vol i. p. 77, referring to a Mussulman legend, says: “Finally, when Adam reached his nine hundred and thirtieth year, the Angel of Death appeared under the form of a goat, and ran between his legs.

“Adam recoiled with horror, and exclaimed, ‘God has given me one thousand years; wherefore comest thou now?’

“‘What!’ exclaimed the Angel of Death, ‘hast thou not given seventy years of thy life to the prophet David?’

“Adam stoutly denied that he had done so. Then the Angel of Death drew the document of transfer from out of his beard, and presented it to Adam, who could no longer refuse to go.”

[C] The Festival of the Invention, or finding of the Cross, is kept in the Roman and English Churches on May 3.

[D] Piscina, a fish-pond: *Lat.* In this instance it is supposed to be the Pool of Bethesda.

[E] Nicodemus, chap. 14:—

But when the first man our father Adam heard these things, that Jesus was baptized in Jordan, he called out to his son Seth, and said,

v. 1.

Declare to your sons, the patriarchs and prophets, all those things which thou didst hear from Michael the Archangel, when I sent thee to the gates of Paradise to entreat God that he would anoint my head when I was sick.

v. 2.

Then Seth, coming near to the patriarchs and prophets, said: I, Seth, when I was praying to God at the gates of Paradise, beheld the angel of the Lord, Michael, appear unto me, saying, I am sent unto thee from the Lord; I am appointed to preside over human bodies.

v. 3

I tell thee, Seth, do not pray to God in tears, and entreat him for the oil of the tree of mercy, wherewith to anoint thy father Adam for his headach;

v. 4.

Because thou canst not by any means obtain it till the last day and times, namely, till five thousand and five hundred years be past.

v. 5.

Then will Christ, the most merciful Son of God, come on earth to raise again the human body of Adam, and at the same time to raise the bodies of the dead, and when he cometh he will be baptized in Jordan;

v. 6.

Then with the oil of his mercy he will anoint all those that believe on him; and the oil of his mercy will continue to future generations, for those who shall be born of the water and the Holy Ghost unto eternal life.

v. 7.

And when at that time the most merciful Son of God, Christ Jesus, shall come down on earth, he will introduce our father Adam into Paradise, to the tree of mercy.

v. 8.

When all the patriarchs and prophets heard all these things from Seth, they rejoiced more.

v. 9.

[E] Alban Butler, in *The Lives of the Fathers, Martyrs, and other Principal Saints*, denies that St. Helena was an Innholder (*Stabularia*) in Bithynia, when Constantius married her, and says: “We are assured by the unanimous tradition of our English historians that this holy empress was a native of our island. William of Malmesbury, the principal historian of the ancient state of our country after Bede, and before him, the Saxon author of the life of St. Helen, in 970, quoted by Usher, expressly say that Constantine was a Briton by birth.” Leland, in his *Commentarii de Scriptoribus Britannicis*, says that St. Helena was the only daughter of King Coilus, the King Cöol who first built walls round Colchester, and the English Church has generally recognised her British origin. Her festival is kept on August 18.

When her husband, Constantine Chlorus, entered into an arrangement with Diocletian, by which he had the countries this side the Alps, namely, Gaul and Britain, he was obliged, as part of the bargain, to divorce St. Helena, and marry Theodora, the daughter-in-law of Maximinianus. According to Eusebius, she was not converted to Christianity at the same time as her son Constantine, who, when he came to the throne, paid her the greatest deference, and gave her the title of Augusta, or empress. After the Council of Nice, in 325, he wrote to Macarius, Bishop of Jerusalem, concerning the building of a splendid church upon Mount Calvary, and St. Helena, although she was then 79 years of age, undertook to see it carried out.

It was then that the reputed Invention of the Cross, together with the nails, took place, and she soon afterwards died, but the exact year is uncertain, some authorities giving A.D. 326, others 328.

[G] Other accounts say the Crosses were found by Macarius, then Bishop of Jerusalem.

[H] The book of the office of Mithras or Mithra, the Sun, worshipped by the Persians.

[I] Heraclius, Emperor of the East, who from A.D. 622 to 627 fought Chosroes II., defeated him, and concluded peace.

[J] St. Equitius was a hermit, and looked after the welfare of other hermits and monks. He took a special interest in a convent of young virgins; died about A.D. 540.

[K] I quote from the translation by Steven Withers, 1561.

[L] From this book I have taken the head and tail piece here given.—J. A.

[M] Arundel, No. 507, and Add. MSS. 6524.

[N] His life and labours may be read in Mr. Hottrop’s *Monuments Typographiques des Pays-bas*—.

[O] See *The Woodcutters of the Netherlands in the 15th Century*, by W. M. Conway, and an article by him in the *Bibliographer* of May, 1883, p. 32.



Seth lieue sone wilt mi wel verstaen
 T o t t e n p a r a d i s e s o e s u l t g h i g a e n
 E n d e d a e r s u l t g h i d e n e n g e l v r a g h e n
 W a n n e e r d a t e y n d e n s e t t e n m i j c l a g h e n

Adam sends Seth to Paradise for some of the Oil of Mercy.



Hier gheeft hem die enghele drie greynen cleer
 Die sal hi begraueu met sinen vader
 Daerof sal wassen enen boeme goet
 Daer Christus aen sal storten sijn bloet

The Archangel Michael gives Seth three seeds of the Tree of Life.



**Hier se gawort Seth sinen vader
Ende hineem die drie gaeften clae
Ende hi heeft se onder sijn tonghe ghelept
Als hem die engel God te gheseyt**

Seth buries Adam and puts the three seeds of the Tree of Life under his tongue.



Dier sijn troghewassen drie couden clare
Die adams graf ende was Iethes vader
Ende die sijn daer bliuen staen
Tot dat se moyses van daer heeft ghedaen

The three seeds spring up.



**Giet rustet moyses in waten talen
Omitten kinderen van yfvel in enen dal
Daer soe siet hi staen al openbaer
Geneuen hem dije roeden claer**

Moses always has the three rods with him.



Hier hebben si den lech hongsuonden
 Ende si murmurēden ten seluen stonden
 Ende si seghen daer al openbaer
 Als dat dat water seer bitter waer

With them he makes water flow from the Rock.



Hier doet den enghel moyses verstaen
Dat hi die waden soude maen
In dat water dat zeer bitter was
Dat is gk worden soe als ic las

An Angel tells Moses how to sweeten the bitter waters.



Hier heeft mofes al sonder faghen
Die roeden int water gheslaghen
Ende hi toechte daer weer
Ende dante god onsen heer

Moses, by dipping the rods in the waters of Marah, sweetens them.



Hier heeft moyses die roeden gheplant
 In dat rijk van moab niet onsegerstant
 Daer soe sijn si alken staen
 Tot dat die dauid van daer heeft ghebaen

Moses plants the rods in the land of Moab.



Hierdoemt die engel wilt my verlaen
 Tot den coninc dauid ghegaen
 Ende hi heeft hem binnen vyen dagen
 Die roeden tot iherusalem doen draeghen

An Angel appears to David and tells him to bring the rods to Jerusalem.



Hier met behuud die roeden goet
 Over aerden des sijt wel vroet.
 Ende si herfter die stelen mede ghemect
 Ende si ligg och allen sieten ghesont ghemact

The rods heal the sick.



**Hier wemt hand nre miñ verstaen
Een groot heer teghens ghegaen
Die was metter lazarien beuaen
Hi wert ghesont doet ons die scäfte verstaen**

The rods heal a leper.



**Hiervoor mit d'roed metten roeden goet
Ende hem comen dyse swarte mannen te noet
Hi tuertese met die roeden saen
Ende daen se worden si wit ghedaen**

The rods turn three black men white.



Hier Brenese dauid seer haestelijck
 Tot iherusalem die roeden oetmoetelijck
 Wer soemoetichdi elacklijken weten
 Dat hy se in sijn eyghen hof heeft gheset

David leaves the rods for the night.



Hier sijn die roeten binnen eenre nacht
Om met die goods hulpe ende cracht
Des wilt doch elcker lieden nemen goet
Ende is ghesworden enen seonen boom

In the morning he finds the rods have taken root and have become one tree.



Hier doet dauid tot seker dien
 Sijn Hofvake ende wel bemueren
 Oeck suldi dat elcken verstaen
 Dat hi hier sijn ghabet heeft ghedaen

David builds a wall round the miraculous tree.



Hier heeft dauid wijsdijt wel verstaen
 Om den boom te wisten cinghen doen staen
 Si waren oec van salueren mede
 Oec doet hi sijn ghebet tot seker stede

David composes the Psalms and praises God, under the shadow of the tree.



Hier coemt salomon dantes sone
 Ende hi sal tytmien goden den tstone
 Een tempel soen ende goet
 Ende hi wet offouden den theme soet

Solomon orders the tree to be cut down and used in the Temple.



Hier gaen smeten ende mercken
Om den boom te legghen inden wercken
Si hebben ghemeyne ende ghepast
Om inden tempel te legghen vast

Artificers fashion the tree.



Hier brengen si die hout te werck
Ende het is te wort nae horen merck
Of het is geworden alte land
Het bleef niet werck teghens horen danc

The holy wood will fit nowhere.



Hier leyt dat hout inden tempel
 Ende daer toe quam een vrouken swaer
 Ende si is op dat hout gheseten daer
 Si verbrande haer cleden dat is waer

St. Maximilla sitting on the wood, her clothes catch alight.



Hiercoome een propheetse als ic verstaet
 Ende si was gheseten sibiila
 Si propheette al openbaer
 Dat christus soude hanghen in dat hout elae

St. Maximilla prophesies concerning the wood.



Ghet omme soe moech bi voerwaer weten
 Ghes dat die ioden si sike hebben ghesmeten
 Ende si hebben haer sulcken noot ghedaen
 Dat si daer van die doot heeft ontfacen

St. Maximilla scourged to death.



**Hier hebben die ioden sul bi verstaen
Dit hout en een rywier ghesdaen
Claerlycken soe selbist verstaen
Om datmen daer ouer soude gaen**

The wood used as a foot-bridge over a brook.



Hier coemt als wy verstaen
 Die conincghinne van Saba ghegaen
 Ende si maecte haer karuot
 Geneuen den houte dat flouetwot

*The Queen of Sheba prefers wading through the brook, to walking over the
 holy wood.*



Gler coemt van saba die coninc ghinne elaar
Ende si bespede salomon al openbaer
Wpe dat hem maecte alsoe stout
Dat hi ouer een reuiere seide dat hout

The Queen of Sheba tells Solomon of the holy nature of the wood.



Hier doet salomon die coninc
 Slaen menighen selonen rince
 Wan siluer ende van goude claet
 Gen dat hout daer gheprust in wilden openbaet

The holy wood is taken up.



Hier doet salom on al sonder saghen
Die hout in den tempel braghen
Ende hi lietet sonen die dore legghen
Ende alle man die moeste den hout te legghen

The holy wood is carried into the Temple.



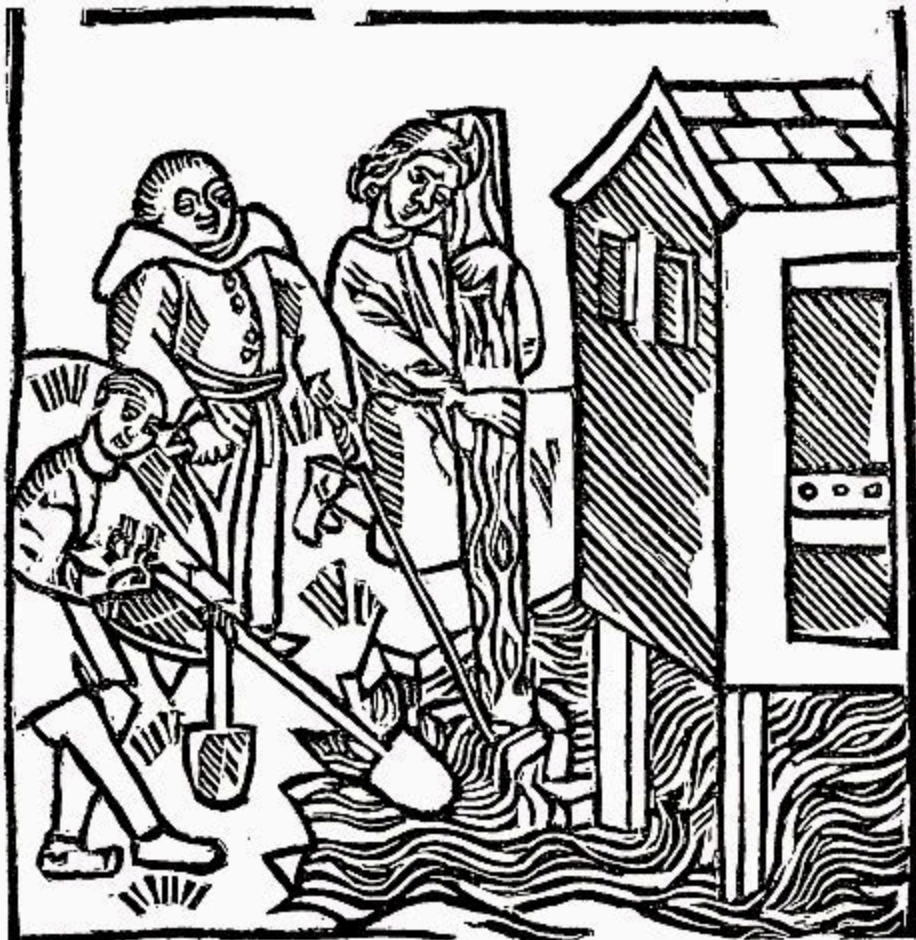
Hier coemt die derde coninc als ic las
 Na salomon gheseten abgas
 Ende hi dede vanden houte nemen daer
 Gout ende sijnuer dat is waer

Abias despoils the holy wood of its precious covering.



Hier comen die loven ghegaen
Ende si hebben dat hout vten tempel ghedaen
Ende si hebben dat hout van deser werden
Ghegraven al onder die aerde

The Jews bury the holy wood.



Hier so hebben Knae vele daghen
 Een psone Gaten gaten
 Daer men in soude wasschen wilt verstoeyn
 Die offerhande wert gheboeyn

Digging the Pool of Bethesda.



Hier coemt die engel alle daghen
 Of totter pilsenen die is ghegauen
 Wie dat naden engel eerst te water quam
 Wan allen sieten dat hi loet vernamen

The sick being healed at the Pool of Bethesda.



Doer priester stont in pylatus huss
Oeghefclende seer con fays
Doen is dat hout van groten louen
Ghemmen totter piscinen bouen

The High Priest told of the discovery of the holy wood.



Hier hebben si ten seluen stonden
Dit hout in dat water gheuonden
Ende daer maecten si of een cruce
Dat ypristus droech seer con fuge

The holy wood is made into the Cross.



Hier is xristus metten crug & ghesaden
Doer ons alre misdaden
Daer aen soude hi betalen gaen
Die souke die adem hadde ghesaden

Christ bearing the Cross.



Dier hanghet oprijsus aenden crups
Belastende seer confus
Ende heeft daer volbaen
Die seult die adam hadde ghebaen

The Crucifixion.



Daer stont dat heylighe cruyts
 Hier ghescheede den daniel groot conveys
 Want alle die ghene die beseten sijn
 Die worden verlost van boerrephijn

Disciples adore the Cross, the sick are healed, and devils cast out.



Hier omme soe roeren die priesters quart
 Ende si namen aen hoerselien enen raet
 Dat si dat crays van groter weerden
 Hebben ghegraven onder die aerde

The Jews bury the Crosses.



Gier quam van romen Helena
Si was keizerinne als ic verstaen
Om te weten die waerheyt
Daer dit cruys is ghelept

St. Helena comes to Jerusalem.



Hier coemt Helena ten sckuendaghen
Ende si seght int om die crups te vraghen
Ende si ontfout die Ioden allegher
Om te weten die werelt seker

St. Helena calls together the Chief Jews.



Hier heeft Helena Judas
 In een put ghestellen als te Rus
 Want si van hem woude weten daer
 Waer dat dat werke crups ghelept waer

Judas is put into a dry well.



Ten eynde van seuen daghen
 Bestont iudas helena te vragen
 Of si hem woude vten putte doen
 Al soude haer wysen dat cruyts schoep

Judas is liberated from confinement.



Doe iudas quam tot d'ler stede
Soe dede hi oetmoedelic sijn ghebede
Doe septe hem die enghele openbaer
Dat daer dat crups ons heren waer

Judas prays for Divine direction.



Hier at beghet Iudas al openbaer
 Om te vinden dat cruceclae
 Dat hi vant als die scrifte belijft
 Oernant hi die nagelen ter seluer tijt

The Crosses are discovered.



Hier coemt vnde meten cruce gden
 Dat hi vonden heeft wil overstaen
 Oec brent hi d'apenaghele goet
 Ende sigheffe der keyserinnen sijt besriet

St. Helena views the Crosses.



Wien weten si niet al openbaer
Wet dattet cruce ons heren waer
Soe namen si die twee cruce daer
Ende si kenden se openen boden dat is waer

Trial of the true Cross.



Doefde namen si ter ſeluer ſtont
 Dat berbe crups ende hi wert ghelont
 Al dus wolſten ſi die waerheyt clær
 Als dat di crups ons heren waer

A dead maiden raised to life by being touched by the true Cross.



Hier heeft Helena batting ons heren
 In twee gedeelte tot gootseren
 Dat een stuc heeft si tot Iherusalem ghesloten
 Dat ander stuc namse mede hore staten

St. Helena deposits a portion of the Cross in Jerusalem.



Hier brent hi des hjt leker ende doet
 Dat anderde stuc vanden cruce goet
 Constantino den keiser openbaer
 Si danctegod vanden hemel dat is waer

St. Helena gives a portion of the Cross to Constantine.



Hier quam tot iherusalem gheuen
 Een tyranne ouer de iheren
 Ende si nam dat werke crijgs ons heren
 Ende si dedet alto seer ontrenen

Constantine deposits his portion of the Cross in Byzantium.



Hier sit woldat al openbaer
 In sinen thron ende seyt hi is duetbaer
 Der heet hi dat erups die soen als men heet
 Ende die heen heet hi die heplighe gheest

Chosroes commands his people to adore him.



Hier quam nu al openbaet
 Een die eruelius heet dat is waer
 Ende hi heeft enen sterke ghebaen
 Teghens den longhen cosbre wiet ing verstaen

Meeting of Heraclius and Chosroes' son.



Desen strit die is gheschiet
Opeenbrugge die danuſſen hiet
Daer god etaclaus den sege gan
Als dat hi den iongken cosroe verwan

Heraclius fights the son of Chosroes and kills him.



Hier coemt dat v oec wilt verstaen
 Ende si sijn tot erackum alle ghesaen
 Ende si sijn ghescomen iont inde ont
 Ghe samen in erackius ghesont

The Persian army submit to Heraclius.



Hiercoemt heraclius die keyser goet
 Totten guden woldas dat sijt vroet
 Ende hi heeft hem te voren gheseyt
 Of hi woude annemen die kerstenheyt

Heraclius visits Chosroes.



Hier heeft heraclius den gheloeft
 Den tyranne of gheslaghen dat heeft
 Hi ont sine lijn den dat verstaet
 Naelijn egghen sonden ende misdact

Heraclius kills Chosroes.



Hier is als wy moghen verstaen
 Den ionghe cosdre kersten ghedaen
 Ende alle sijn volc des seluer tijt
 Wert kersten ter seluer tijt

Heraclius crowns and baptizes the son of Chosroes.



Hier raeken den oudemroze begraef
 Den ionghen hi weder omme begraef
 Ende hi gheeft hem weder alle gader
 Dat riken dat toepluch te hoey si en vader

Burial of Chosroes.



Hier gaet erackius met haesticheyt
 Ende neemt dat hout der heylighyt
 Ende hi toech daer mede son der oetmoet
 Tot iherusalem als ick verstoet

Heraclius takes possession of the relic of the Cross.



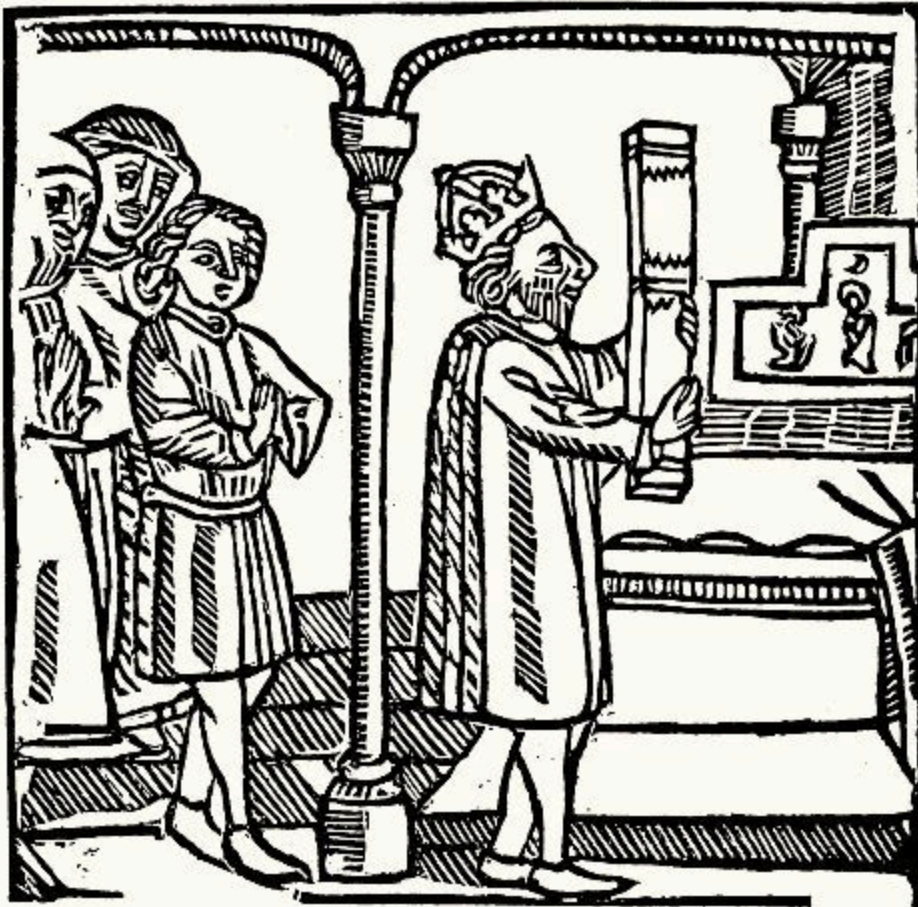
Hiermoechdi sien clær kint
 Dat die engel stoet die poert seker kint
 Ende septe dat doer sijn oetmoet
 Daer goud in ghinc bloethests ende caru oet

*Heraclius, attempting to enter Jerusalem, is miraculously prevented, and is
 reprov'd by an angel.*



Hier maect hem met haesten groot
 Heraclius bloets heeft ende baruoets
 Ende sijn ghecomen dat wel verstaet
 Oetmoedelijc tot iherusalem op die straet

Heraclius divests himself of state.



Hier coemt eraclius sekerlych
 Totten tempel seer oetmoedelych
 Gh si brenct dat heylighe hout daert plaet te staen
 Oetmoedelych heeft hi ihu ghedat ghedaen

Heraclius places the relic of the Cross in its appointed place.



Hier sijn coepluden in gwoet noot
 Ende si meenden hier te bliuen doot
 Si aenbeden dat heylighe cruce oetmoedelike
 God die heeste verlost sekerlike

A portion of the Cross is sent to Rome, the vessel bearing it meeting with a storm.



Hier toey ble oepstuden openster
Thaer offerhande ten cruce claer
Ick bidde god den hemelstien vader
Wat si ons voer den buwel becoere

The relic of the Cross exposed for adoration.

Transcriber's Notes:

All spelling, capitalization, and punctuation inconsistencies retained.

Page ix, number added to sidenote. (²*Hadrian is said to*)

Page xxii, number added to sidenote. (⁷*Of old.*)

Page xxxvii, anchor for sidenote 28 added to text. (torne thys bane²⁸)

Page lii, anchor for sidenote 39 added to text. (had been peasyd³⁹)

Page lxxvii and following, the totals were removed until the final one. Each page ended with a total, such as:

Chalmarques	<u>"</u>
Carried forward	1,674,145

The following page began with something similar to:

Brought forward	1,674,145
Châlons	200

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